

Gestalten

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1 Presentable categories

Talk given by Sil.

1.1 Preliminaries

Concepts we should know:

- (-2) *Regular cardinal κ* : any union of sets of cardinality $< \kappa$ indexed by a set of cardinality $< \kappa$ has cardinality $< \kappa$.
- (-1) *Essentially κ -small (∞ -)category C* : (If κ uncountable) The set of isomorphism classes of C has cardinality $< \kappa$, and for all $x, y \in C$ the homotopy groups $\pi_i \operatorname{hom}_C(X, Y)$ have cardinality $< \kappa$ (For $\kappa = \aleph_0$ one would take the smallest subcategory of $\operatorname{Cat}_\infty$ generated under finite colimits by $[0]$ and $[1]$);
- (0) *κ -filtered category I* : Every κ -small diagram in I admits a cocone;
- (1) *κ -compact object $X \in C$* : $\operatorname{Hom}_C(X, -): C \rightarrow \mathbf{An}$ preserves κ -filtered colimits;
- (2) *κ -presentable categories*: A category C which has small colimits and such that every object is a κ -filtered colimit of κ -compact objects;
- (3) *Presentable categories*: A category C which is κ -presentable for some κ .

Remark 1.1. C is presentable iff it “admits a presentation:” There is a small category S such that $C \simeq \langle S \rangle[R^{-1}]$, where $\langle S \rangle = \operatorname{PSh}(S) = \operatorname{Fun}(S^{\operatorname{op}}, \mathbf{An})$ is the free cocompletion of S , where R is a (small) set of morphisms in $\langle S \rangle$, and where $\langle S \rangle[R^{-1}] \subseteq \langle S \rangle$ is the full subcategory spanned by those $X \in \langle S \rangle$ such that $\operatorname{Hom}_{\langle S \rangle}(f, X): \operatorname{Hom}_{\langle S \rangle}(B, X) \rightarrow \operatorname{Hom}_{\langle S \rangle}(A, X)$ is an isomorphism for every morphism $f: A \rightarrow B$ in R .

Similarly, C is κ -presentable if we can choose S and R above such that R consists of maps between κ -compact objects.

Remark 1.2. The description of $\langle S \rangle[R^{-1}]$ as a full subcategory of $\langle S \rangle$ is an instance of the principle that “free constructions in Pr^L correspond to cofree constructions in Cat , via passing to right adjoints.” Indeed, the localization functor $\langle S \rangle \rightarrow \langle S \rangle[R^{-1}]$ is a morphism in Pr^L , hence preserves colimits and admits a right adjoint; this right adjoint is automatically fully faithful and identifies $\langle S \rangle[R^{-1}]$ with the subcategory described above. See [Lur09, Proposition 5.5.4.20].

Definition 1.3. We denote by $\mathbf{Pr}^L$ the category of presentable categories and cocontinuous functors. We let $\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L \subseteq \mathbf{Pr}^L$ denote the (non-full) subcategory of κ -presentable categories and those cocontinuous functors which preserve κ -compact objects.

Example 1.4. The categories $\mathbf{An}$, $\mathbf{Sp}$, $D(R)$ are all in $\mathbf{Pr}_{\aleph_0}^L$. For X a locally compact Hausdorff space, $\mathbf{Shv}(X) \in \mathbf{Pr}_{\aleph_1}^L$. Also the category of almost modules is $\aleph_1$ -presentable.

Lemma 1.5. Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal. If D is κ -presentable and I is a κ -small category, then also $\mathbf{Fun}(I, D)$ is κ -presentable. Its κ -compact generators are given by $\mathbf{Fun}(I, D^\kappa)$.

Proof. This follows from the argument given in [Lur09, Proposition 5.4.4.3]; note that no enlargement of the regular cardinal is needed: since I is κ -small, the argument only uses that κ -filtered colimits of anima commute with κ -small limits. $\square$

Definition 1.6. Let $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ be the category of categories with κ -small colimits. (In the case $\kappa = \aleph_0$ we assume the categories are additionally idempotent complete).

Proposition 1.7. Let C be a κ -presentable category. Then the subcategory $C^\kappa \subseteq C$ is essentially small, and the inclusion $C^\kappa \hookrightarrow C$ uniquely extends to an equivalence $\mathbf{Ind}_\kappa(C^\kappa) \xrightarrow{\sim} C$. Moreover, the assignments $C \mapsto C^\kappa$ and $D \mapsto \mathbf{Ind}_\kappa(D)$ define an equivalence

$$\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa \rightleftarrows \mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L.$$

Theorem 1.8. The category $\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L$ is κ -presentable. (In other words: $\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L \in \mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L$.)

Proof. By the previous proposition, $\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L$ is equivalent to $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$, so we need to show $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ is κ -presentable. To this end, we consider the free-forgetful adjunction

$$\mathbf{fgt}: \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa \rightleftarrows \mathbf{Cat}: \langle - \rangle^\kappa.$$

We will first show that this adjunction is monadic. By the Barr–Beck theorem, we need to show:

- The functor $\mathbf{fgt}$ is conservative. This is clear.
- The category $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ admits $\mathbf{fgt}$ -split simplicial colimits, and $\mathbf{fgt}: \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$ preserves these. Here we say that a functor $C_\bullet: \Delta^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ is *fgt-split* if its image $\mathbf{fgt}(C_\bullet): \Delta^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$ admits a splitting.

For the second claim, consider such a diagram $C_\bullet$. Let $C_{-1} := \text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\text{op}}} C_n$ be its colimit in $\mathbf{Cat}$. Then one can show that C_{-1} admits κ -small colimits, and moreover each functor $C_n \rightarrow C_{-1}$ preserves κ -small colimits. In particular, the augmented simplicial object in $\mathbf{Cat}$ lifts to one in $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$. We now claim that this diagram is a colimit in $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$. To see this, let $D \in \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ be any other object. We need to show that $\mathbf{Hom}_{\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa}(C_{-1}, D) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[n] \in \Delta} \mathbf{Hom}_{\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa}(C_n, D)$. **To do.**

We now know that $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ is monadic over $\mathbf{Cat}$. Moreover, $\mathbf{Cat}$ is $\aleph_0$ -presentable, as it is a Bousfield localization of $\mathbf{sAn} = \mathbf{Fun}(\Delta^{\text{op}}, \mathbf{An})$ at finitely many morphisms. We conclude that $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ admits all colimits, and it is generated by the objects $\langle [n] \rangle^\kappa$. So it suffices to show that these categories are κ -compact in $\mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$. Since $[n] \in \mathbf{Cat}$ is κ -compact (even $\aleph_0$ -compact), it suffices to show that $\langle - \rangle^\kappa: \mathbf{Cat} \rightarrow \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa$ preserves κ -compact objects. This is equivalent to the claim that its right adjoint $\mathbf{fgt}: \mathbf{Rex}_\kappa \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$ preserves κ -filtered colimits, which is an easy computation. $\square$

Proposition 1.9. *The object $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ of $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ is κ -compact if and only if κ is not a limit cardinal. (In particular, this applies to $\kappa = \aleph_1$.)*

Lemma 1.10. *Let $F: C \rightarrow D$ be a morphism in $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$, and let G denote its right adjoint. Then the following are equivalent:*

(1) *The functor F is fully faithful;*

(2) *The induced functor*

$$F^\kappa: C^\kappa \rightarrow D^\kappa$$

is fully faithful;

(3) *The unit $\eta_X: X \rightarrow GFX$ is an equivalence for every $X \in C^\kappa$.*

Proof. The implication (1) $\Rightarrow$ (3) is the usual adjunction criterion for full faithfulness. The implication (3) $\Rightarrow$ (2) follows from the adjunction: for $X, Y \in C^\kappa$, we have

$$\text{Hom}_D(FX, FY) \simeq \text{Hom}_C(X, GFY) \simeq \text{Hom}_C(X, Y).$$

Conversely, assume that F^κ is fully faithful. For $Y \in C^\kappa$, the map $\eta_Y: Y \rightarrow GFY$ induces, for every $X \in C^\kappa$, the map

$$\text{Hom}_C(X, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_C(X, GFY) \simeq \text{Hom}_D(FX, FY),$$

which is an equivalence by assumption. Since the κ -compact objects generate C under colimits, this implies that η_Y is an equivalence. Thus (2) $\Rightarrow$ (3).

It remains to see that (2) implies (1). Consider the subcategory $C' \subseteq C$ consisting of those objects X such that the map $\text{Hom}_C(X, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_D(FX, FY)$ is an isomorphism for each $Y \in C$. Note that we have $C^\kappa \subseteq C'$: if X is κ -compact, then both $\text{Hom}_C(X, -)$ and $\text{Hom}_D(FX, F(-))$ preserve κ -filtered colimits, and every $Y \in C$ may be written as a κ -filtered colimit of κ -compact objects. Also note that C' is closed under arbitrary colimits, since both $\text{Hom}_C(-, Y)$ and $\text{Hom}_D(F(-), FY)$ send colimits in X to limits. It follows that $C' = C$, showing that F is fully faithful. $\square$

1.2 Basic properties of Pr^{L}

Theorem 1.11. *Let $F: C \rightarrow D$ be a functor between $C, D \in \text{Pr}^{\text{L}}$.*

(1) *Then F admits a right adjoint if and only if it preserves colimits.*

(2) *Moreover, F admits a left adjoint if and only if it preserves limits and it is κ -accessible for some regular cardinal κ (i.e. it preserves κ -filtered colimits).*

Corollary 1.12. *There is an equivalence $(\text{Pr}^{\text{L}})^{\text{op}} \simeq \text{Pr}^{\text{R}}$.*

Proposition 1.13. (1) *The category Pr^{L} admits small limits, which are preserved by $\text{fgt}: \text{Pr}^{\text{L}} \rightarrow \text{Cat}$.*

(2) *The category $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ admits limits, preserved by the composite*

$$\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} \simeq \text{Rex}_\kappa \rightarrow \text{Cat}.$$

(3) If κ is uncountable, then the inclusion $\mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^L \hookrightarrow \mathrm{Pr}^L$ preserves κ -small limits.

Proof. For (1) and (3) we refer to Lurie's HTT. For (2), one needs to use that $\mathrm{Rex}_\kappa \rightarrow \mathrm{Cat}$ is monadic. $\square$

Proposition 1.14. *The categories Pr^R and Pr_κ^R admit small limits, and the functors $\mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^R \rightarrow \mathrm{Pr}^R \rightarrow \mathrm{Cat}$ preserve small limits.*

Corollary 1.15. *The categories Pr^L and Pr_κ^L admit colimits (which are computed by passing to adjoints and computing the limit in Pr^R resp. Pr_κ^R .)*

Example 1.16. Let I be a set.

- (1) The product $\prod_{i \in I} C_i$ in Pr^L is just the product of underlying categories. But the product in Pr_κ^L would be $\mathrm{Ind}_\kappa(\prod_{i \in I} C_i^\kappa)$.
- (2) The coproduct $\coprod_{i \in I} C_i$ in Pr^L is also the product $\prod_{i \in I} C_i$ in Cat . So is the coproduct in Pr_κ^L .
- (3) The pushout of $*/H$ and $*/G$ over $*$ is $*/(G \star H)$, where $G \star H$ is the free product of G and H , and where $*/G$ denotes the classifying anima of G . But the pushout $\langle */H \rangle \sqcup_{\langle * \rangle} \langle */G \rangle$ is given by the pullback $\langle */H \rangle \times_{\mathrm{An}} \langle */G \rangle$ in Cat .

Remark 1.17. Item (2) of the previous example is striking: the natural map

$$\coprod_{i \in I} C_i \rightarrow \prod_{i \in I} C_i$$

in Pr^L is an isomorphism for *arbitrary* indexing sets I . Adapting the notion of *semiadditivity* from [Lur17, Definition 6.1.6.13] to arbitrary cardinals, this says that Pr^L is κ -semiadditive for every cardinal κ . This is an extremely unusual property of Pr^L .

The analogous statement in Pr_κ^L requires $|I| < \kappa$: the coproduct $\coprod_{i \in I}^{\mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^L} C_i$ is always the naive product $\prod_i C_i$, whereas the product $\prod_{i \in I}^{\mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^L} C_i = \mathrm{Ind}_\kappa(\prod_i C_i^\kappa)$ generally differs from it; the two agree precisely when $|I| < \kappa$.

1.3 Tensor products in Pr^L

Proposition 1.18. *Let $C, D \in \mathrm{Pr}^L$. There exists a universal presentable category $C \otimes D$ with a functor $C \times D \rightarrow C \otimes D$ which preserves colimits in both variables. If $C, D \in \mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^L$, then $C \otimes D \in \mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^L$, and the functor $C \times D \rightarrow C \otimes D$ preserves κ -compact objects.*

Proof. We may set $\langle S \rangle \otimes \langle D \rangle = \langle S \times T \rangle$. Moreover, we may set $\langle S \rangle[R^{-1}] \otimes \langle T \rangle[Q^{-1}] = \langle S \times T \rangle[(R \times Q)^{-1}]$. $\square$

Corollary 1.19. *The categories Pr^L and Pr_κ^L admit symmetric monoidal structures $\mathrm{Pr}^{L, \otimes}, \mathrm{Pr}_\kappa^{L, \otimes}$.*

Proof. We define these as suboperads of $\mathrm{CAT}^\times$. $\square$

Example 1.20. (1) For $C = \langle S \rangle$, we get $C \otimes D \simeq \mathrm{Fun}(S^{\mathrm{op}}, D)$.

- (2) For $C \in \text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ and $D \in \text{Pr}^{\text{L}}$, then $C \otimes D \simeq \text{Fun}^{\kappa\text{-lex}}((C^\kappa)^{\text{op}}, D)$.
- (3) Let A be a (static) ring. Then $D_{\geq 0}(A)$ has compact projective generators A^n for $n \geq 0$, so $D_{\geq 0}(A) \simeq \text{Fun}^\times(\{A^n\}^{\text{op}}, \text{An})$. It follows that

$$D_{\geq 0}(A) \otimes C \simeq \text{Fun}^\times(\{A^n\}^{\text{op}}, C).$$

(Objects of the RHS are also known as *A-module objects in C*.)

Proposition 1.21. *The symmetric monoidal category $\text{Pr}^{L, \otimes}$ is closed monoidal, with internal hom given by*

$$[C, D] = \text{Fun}^{\text{L}}(C, D),$$

the full subcategory of $\text{Fun}(C, D)$ spanned by the colimit-preserving functors.

Moreover, also $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{L, \otimes}$ is closed monoidal, with internal hom

$$[C, D] = \text{Ind}_\kappa(\text{Fun}^{\kappa\text{-rex}}(C^\kappa, D^\kappa)).$$

Proof. A colimit-preserving functor $E \rightarrow \text{Fun}^{\text{L}}(C, D)$ is the same as a functor $E \times C \rightarrow D$ which preserves colimits in both variables, which by universality is the same as a colimit-preserving functor $E \otimes C \rightarrow D$. It remains to show that $\text{Fun}^{\text{L}}(C, D)$ is presentable. Since κ -small limits in Pr^{L} and $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ agree, we may reduce to the case $C = \langle [n] \rangle^\kappa$. Unwinding the statement in this case, we must prove that for every $D \in \text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$, the functor

$$\text{Ind}_\kappa(\text{Fun}([n], D^\kappa)) \rightarrow \text{Fun}([n], \text{Ind}_\kappa(D^\kappa))$$

is an equivalence. This is HTT.5.3.5.15. □

Proposition 1.22. *We have $(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})^\otimes \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$.*

Proof. Since $(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})^\otimes \simeq \text{Rex}_\kappa^\otimes$, it suffices to prove the claim for the latter. The only thing that remains is to show that the functor

$$- \otimes -: \text{Rex}_\kappa \times \text{Rex}_\kappa \rightarrow \text{Rex}_\kappa$$

preserves κ -compact objects. This in turn reduces to the claim that the tensor product of $\langle [n] \rangle^\kappa$ and $\langle [m] \rangle^\kappa$ is κ -compact. But this tensor product is $\langle [n] \times [m] \rangle^\kappa$, which is indeed κ -compact. □

1.4 C-linear presentable categories

Consider $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$. For $A \in \text{CAlg}(C)$, we may consider the module category $\text{Mod}_A(C) \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$. Moreover, the forgetful functor $\text{Mod}_A(C) \rightarrow C$ admits a left adjoint

$$\text{free}: C \rightarrow \text{Mod}_A(C), \quad X \mapsto A \otimes X,$$

which defines a functor in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$.

Given two A -modules M, M' , we obtain a *relative tensor product over A*

$$M \otimes_A M' = \text{colim}_{\Delta^{\text{op}}} \left(\dots \begin{array}{c} \rightrightarrows \\ \rightrightarrows \\ \rightrightarrows \end{array} M \otimes A \otimes A \otimes M' \begin{array}{c} \rightrightarrows \\ \rightrightarrows \\ \rightrightarrows \end{array} M \otimes A \otimes M' \rightrightarrows M \otimes M' \right).$$

Definition 1.23. Let $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$. Then we may form the module category $\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$ (where we are using that $\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$). We refer to the objects of $\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$ as *C-linear κ -presentable categories* and to its morphisms as *C-linear functors*.

Given $D \in \text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ and $B \in \text{CAlg}(D)$, there is always an equivalence

$$\text{CAlg}(D)_{B/} \simeq \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_B(D)).$$

Theorem 1.24. Given $A \in \text{CAlg}(C)$ as before, the relative tensor product defines a symmetric monoidal structure on $\text{Mod}_A(C)$, turning the module category into an object

$$\text{Mod}_A(C) \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})) \simeq \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})_{C/}.$$

Moreover, the assignment $A \mapsto \text{Mod}_A(C)$ defines a fully faithful functor

$$\text{Mod}_{(-)}(C) : \text{CAlg}(C) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}))$$

which is moreover a morphism in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$. Its right adjoint

$$\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1}) : \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(C)$$

sends an object $D \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})_{C/}$ to the endomorphism object of its monoidal unit. This functor preserves κ -filtered colimits.

Notation 1.25. For $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$, we denote the adjunction of Theorem 1.24 by

$$\text{CAlg}(C) \xrightleftharpoons[E_C]{M_C} \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_C(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})),$$

where $M_C(R) = \text{Mod}_R(C)$ is fully faithful and $E_C(D) = \text{End}_D(\mathbb{1}_D)$ is its right adjoint.

1.5 Stefanich rings

Definition 1.26. We define the category of 2-presentable categories as

$$2\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} = \text{Mod}_{\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}) \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}).$$

By induction, we more generally define $n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ for every $n \geq 0$ by setting

$$(n+1)\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} := \text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}) \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}).$$

(We set $1\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} := \text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ and $0\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}} = \text{An}$.)

For every $n \geq 0$, applying Notation 1.25 for $C = n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}$ gives embeddings

$$M_{n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}} : \text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}((n+1)\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}), \quad C \mapsto \text{Mod}_C(n\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}}).$$

From now on, we will fix $\kappa = \aleph_1$ and set $n\text{Pr} := n\text{Pr}_{\aleph_1}^{\text{L}}$.

Remark 1.27. The role of this cutoff $\kappa = \aleph_1$ is the following. The relative tensor product $M \otimes_A M'$ defined above is computed as the geometric realization of the bar complex, hence as a *countable* colimit. To make sense of the basic theory of modules within $\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L$, we therefore need countable colimits to exist and be preserved by the relevant constructions, forcing $\kappa \geq \aleph_1$.

Definition 1.28. We define the category of *Stefanich rings* as the colimit

$$\mathbf{StRing} := \operatorname{colim}(\mathbf{CAlg}(1\mathbf{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \mathbf{CAlg}(2\mathbf{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \dots \hookrightarrow \mathbf{CAlg}(n\mathbf{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \dots) \in \mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^L).$$

Remark 1.29. Equivalently, passing to the right adjoints $E_{n\mathbf{Pr}}$ of Notation 1.25 gives

$$\mathbf{StRing} = \lim(\dots \xrightarrow{E_{2\mathbf{Pr}}} \mathbf{CAlg}(2\mathbf{Pr}) \xrightarrow{E_{1\mathbf{Pr}}} \mathbf{CAlg}(1\mathbf{Pr}) \xrightarrow{E_{0\mathbf{Pr}}} \mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{An})).$$

2 Quasicoherent sheaves of higher categories I

Talk given by Christoph.

The eventual goal is to construct higher analogues of quasicoherent sheaves on fpqc-stacks. In this talk we treat the affine case, meaning stacks of the form $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ for a commutative ring spectrum $A \in \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$. We write

$$\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}} := \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})^{\mathrm{op}},$$

and denote by $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ the object of $\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ corresponding to A . A map $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ in $\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ is the same thing as a map $A \rightarrow B$ in $\mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$.

For each such affine $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$ we will define presentable categories

$$0\mathrm{Pr}_A, 1\mathrm{Pr}_A, 2\mathrm{Pr}_A, \dots$$

which should be thought of as higher versions of $\mathrm{QCoh}(\mathrm{Spec}(A))$. These categories are not ad hoc: they are the components of the Stefanich ring associated to A .

2.1 Affine Stefanich rings

Recall that $1\mathrm{Pr} = \mathrm{Pr}_{\mathbb{N}_1}^{\mathrm{L}}$ and that, for $n \geq 1$, the higher categories $n\mathrm{Pr}$ are defined by

$$(n+1)\mathrm{Pr} := \mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}}(1\mathrm{Pr}).$$

The category of Stefanich rings is the colimit

$$\mathrm{StRing} := \mathrm{colim}(\mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr}) \xrightarrow{M_{1\mathrm{Pr}}} \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr}) \xrightarrow{M_{2\mathrm{Pr}}} \dots)$$

where the transition functors are the embeddings from Notation 1.25. Equivalently, it is the limit of the categories $\mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})$ along the endomorphism algebra functors $E_{n\mathrm{Pr}}$.

Now let $A \in \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$. We first regard A through its category of modules

$$0\mathrm{Pr}_A := \mathrm{Mod}_A(\mathrm{Sp}) \in \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr}).$$

Applying the functor M_{Sp} from Notation 1.25 gives a fully faithful functor

$$\mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp}) \xrightarrow{M_{\mathrm{Sp}}} \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Mod}_{\mathrm{Sp}}(1\mathrm{Pr})) \hookrightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \mathrm{StRing}.$$

We denote the Stefanich ring associated to A by

$$A \mapsto (0\mathrm{Pr}_A, 1\mathrm{Pr}_A, 2\mathrm{Pr}_A, \dots).$$

Unwinding the embeddings into StRing gives, for $n \geq 1$,

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_A \simeq \mathrm{Mod}_{(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_A}(1\mathrm{Pr}).$$

More precisely, $n\mathrm{Pr}_A$ is a commutative algebra over $n\mathrm{Pr}$, i.e. an object of

$$\mathrm{CAlg}((n+1)\mathrm{Pr}) \simeq \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}}(1\mathrm{Pr})) \simeq \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/},$$

and the structure map $n\mathrm{Pr} \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_A$ is obtained from $(n-1)\mathrm{Pr} \rightarrow (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_A$ by passing to modules in $1\mathrm{Pr}$.

A map $f: A \rightarrow B$ in $\mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$ induces, by functoriality of the Stefanich-ring embedding, symmetric monoidal pullback functors

$$f_n^*: n\mathrm{Pr}_A \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_B$$

for all $n \geq 0$. Concretely, f_0^* is extension of scalars along f , and for $n > 0$ the functor f_n^* is extension of scalars along

$$f_{n-1}^*: (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_A \rightarrow (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_B.$$

Definition 2.1. A map $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ in $\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ is called *countably presented* if B is $\aleph_1$ -compact as an object of $\mathrm{CAlg}_A(\mathrm{Sp})$. Equivalently, the subcategory of $\mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})_{A/}$ spanned by the countably presented maps is the smallest subcategory containing the polynomial algebra on one generator over A which is closed under countable colimits.

Observation 2.2. The basic closure properties of countably presented maps follow from the compact algebra lemmas in Section A.1, applied with $\kappa = \aleph_1$ and $C = \mathrm{Sp}$. We will spell out the particular consequences needed later in Lemma 4.3.

Our first main goal is to promote the assignments $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_A$ to a six-functor formalism on affines:

Theorem 2.3. *For every $n \geq 0$, there exists a 6-functor formalism*

$$\mathrm{Span}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}, \text{all, countably presented maps}) \rightarrow 1\mathrm{Pr}, \quad \mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_A.$$

On a span in $\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$, equivalently a cospan in $\mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$ of the form

$$A \xrightarrow{f} B \xleftarrow{f'} C$$

the desired functor acts by pullback along f followed by pushforward along f' :

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_A \xrightarrow{f_n^*} n\mathrm{Pr}_B \xrightarrow{f'_{n,*}} n\mathrm{Pr}_C,$$

where $f'_{n,*}$ is right adjoint to f_n^* . The next two sections verify the formal properties needed for these assignments to define the stated six-functor formalism.

2.2 Extension and restriction of scalars

Consider some $\mathcal{V} \in \mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{Pr}^{\mathbf{L}})$. Given a map $g: R \rightarrow S$ in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathcal{V})$, we obtain an adjunction

$$g^*: \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V}) \rightleftarrows \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}): g_*$$

given by extension/restriction of scalars. The functor g^* is given on underlying objects in $\mathcal{V}$ by $M \mapsto M \otimes_R S$. It is symmetric monoidal.

We recall some basic properties of this adjunction:

- (a) The functor $g_*: \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V})$ commutes with the forgetful functors to $\mathcal{V}$. It is functorial in g : we have $(g'g)_* \simeq g_*g'_*$. Consequently, g^* is functorial in g .
- (b) The functor g^* preserves free modules. By definition, an S -module is called *free* if it is in the image of the functor $f^*: \mathcal{V} \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V})$, $M \mapsto S \otimes M$ defined as extension of scalars along $f: \mathbb{1} \rightarrow R$. So the claim follows from the fact that the composite $\mathbb{1} \rightarrow R \rightarrow S$ is the unit map $\mathbb{1} \rightarrow S$.
- (c) The functor $g_*: \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V})$ preserves colimits. This holds because the map $\mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathcal{V}$ creates colimits.
- (d) The functor g_* satisfies the **projection formula**: for $N \in \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V})$ and $M \in \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V})$, the map

$$M \otimes_R g_* N \rightarrow g_*(g^* M \otimes_S N)$$

adjoint to $g^*(M \otimes_R g_* N) \simeq g^* M \otimes_S g^* g_* N \rightarrow g^* M \otimes_S N$ is an isomorphism. Since both sides preserve colimits in M , we may reduce the claim to the case of a free module $M = f^* M' = R \otimes M'$, in which case we see that both sides reduce to $M' \otimes g_* N$ by an explicit computation of the formula for the relative tensor product.

- (e) The functors g_* satisfy **base change**: Consider a pushout square in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathcal{V})$ of the form

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R & \longrightarrow & S \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ T & \longrightarrow & U, \end{array}$$

meaning that $U \simeq T \otimes_R S$ as commutative algebras. By passing to extension of scalar functions, we obtain a commutative diagram in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{1Pr})$ of the form

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V}) & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathbf{Mod}_T(\mathcal{V}) & \longrightarrow & \mathbf{Mod}_U(\mathcal{V}). \end{array}$$

The horizontal functors have right adjoints, and we need to show that both composites $\mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_T(\mathcal{V})$ agree, along the canonical map. Computing both sides, we get $T \otimes_R M$ versus $(T \otimes_R S) \otimes_S M$, and these agree. (Details omitted.)

- (f) Finally, assume that $\mathcal{V} \in \mathbf{CAlg}(1\mathbf{Pr})$, and let $g: R \rightarrow S$ be a countably presented map, meaning that $S \in \mathbf{CAlg}_R(\mathcal{V})^{\aleph_1}$. Then the functor

$$g_*: \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V})$$

preserves $\aleph_1$ -compact objects by Corollary A.3, applied with $\kappa = \aleph_1$ and $C = \mathcal{V}$.

2.3 Construction of the six-functor formalism

We now construct the six-functor formalism for every $n \geq 0$. For $n = 0$, we have $\mathcal{V} = \mathbf{Sp}$, and we have the functor $\mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{CAlg}(1\mathbf{Pr})$, $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto 0\mathrm{Pr}_A = \mathbf{Mod}_A(\mathbf{Sp})$. We then established all the relevant properties to deduce that the assignment $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto 0\mathrm{Pr}_A = \mathbf{Mod}_A(\mathbf{Sp})$ extends to a six-functor formalism

$$\mathrm{Span}(\mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Pr}^{\mathrm{L}}, \quad \mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto 0\mathrm{Pr}_A$$

where all maps in $\mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ are treated as “proper” maps (i.e. we always pick the right adjoint). Moreover, if we restrict the right-way maps to the countably presented maps, then the functors f_* preserve $\aleph_1$ -compact objects, so this functor restricts to

$$\mathrm{Span}(\mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}, \text{all, countably presented}) \rightarrow 1\mathbf{Pr}.$$

Now assume $n > 0$. Notice that if the map $R \rightarrow S$ in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathcal{V})$ is countably presented, then so is the induced map $\mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V}) \rightarrow \mathbf{Mod}_S(\mathcal{V})$ in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{Mod}_{\mathcal{V}}(1\mathbf{Pr})) \simeq \mathbf{CAlg}_{\mathcal{V}}(1\mathbf{Pr})$. (One can see this by observing that the assignment $R \mapsto \mathbf{Mod}_R(\mathcal{V})$ preserves $\aleph_1$ -compact objects, since its right adjoint $D \mapsto \mathrm{End}_{\mathbb{L}}(D)$ preserves $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits.) So by induction, each functor $f_n^*: n\mathrm{Pr}_A \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_B$ is countably presented whenever $f: A \rightarrow B$ is. We may then consider the composite

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_{(-)}: \mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}^{\mathrm{op}} \xrightarrow{(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_{(-)}} \mathbf{CAlg}(n\mathbf{Pr}) \xrightarrow{\mathbf{Mod}_{(-)}(n\mathbf{Pr})} \mathbf{CAlg}((n+1)\mathbf{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathbf{CAlg}(1\mathbf{Pr}).$$

Then we may apply properties (a)–(f) to get the desired six-functor formalism

$$\mathrm{Span}(\mathbf{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}, \text{all, countably presented}) \rightarrow 1\mathbf{Pr}, \quad \mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_A$$

for every $n \geq 1$. Since the unit $\mathbb{S}$ is mapped to $n\mathrm{Pr}_{\mathbb{S}}$, this functor canonically factors through $\mathbf{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_{\mathbb{S}}}(1\mathbf{Pr}) \subseteq (n+1)\mathbf{Pr}$.

Observation 2.4. Let $f: A \rightarrow B$ be a countably presented map in $\mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{Sp})$. Then, for every $n \geq 0$, the object $n\mathrm{Pr}_B \in (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_A \simeq \mathbf{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_A}(1\mathbf{Pr})$ is $\aleph_1$ -compact.

Indeed, for $n = 0$ this is the compactness assertion used in property (f) above. For $n > 0$, the preceding discussion shows inductively that $n\mathrm{Pr}_B$ is countably presented over $n\mathrm{Pr}_A$ as a commutative algebra, equivalently by Lemma A.1 as a module. In particular, it is $\aleph_1$ -compact as an object of $\mathbf{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_A}(1\mathbf{Pr})$.

2.4 Ambidexterity

It turns out that for $n \geq 1$ the symmetric monoidal pullback functor f_n^* admits not only a well-behaved right adjoint $f_{n,*}$, but also a left adjoint, and the two coincide. This phenomenon, of a functor having identical left and right adjoints, is known as *ambidexterity*, a term introduced by Hopkins–Lurie [HL13]. Before applying this to our functors f_n^* , we set up the general framework.

Definition 2.5. Let C be an $(\infty, 2)$ -category, and let $F: X \rightarrow Y$ be a 1-morphism in C .

- We say F is a *left adjoint* if there exist a 1-morphism $F^R: Y \rightarrow X$ together with 2-morphisms

$$\eta: \text{id}_X \rightarrow F^R F \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(X), \quad \varepsilon: F F^R \rightarrow \text{id}_Y \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(Y),$$

such that the composites

$$F \xrightarrow{F\eta} F F^R F \xrightarrow{\varepsilon F} F \quad \text{and} \quad F^R \xrightarrow{\eta F^R} F^R F F^R \xrightarrow{F^R \varepsilon} F^R$$

are equivalent to the identity.

- Dually, F is a *right adjoint* if there exist a 1-morphism $F^L: Y \rightarrow X$ and 2-morphisms $\eta: \text{id}_X \rightarrow F F^L$, $\varepsilon: F^L F \rightarrow \text{id}_Y$ satisfying the analogous triangle identities.

For the present discussion the reader may take C to be an object of 2Pr , though the definition makes sense for any reasonable notion of $(\infty, 2)$ -category. If F is a left adjoint, the right adjoint F^R is determined up to canonical isomorphism, and the left adjoint of F^R is again F (with the same η and ε).

Remark 2.6. In our formalism of presentable (∞, n) -categories, there are forgetful functors $n\text{Pr} \rightarrow k\text{Pr}$ for any $k \leq n$. Indeed, the symmetric monoidal functor $\text{An} \rightarrow 1\text{Pr}$ (since An is the unit object) yields, by passing to modules, symmetric monoidal functors $n\text{Pr} \rightarrow (n+1)\text{Pr}$ inductively, whose right adjoints are the desired forgetful functors. In particular, Definition 2.5 applies to 1-morphisms in $n\text{Pr}$ for any $n \geq 2$.

We can now state the general ambidexterity result.

Proposition 2.7. *Let C be an $(\infty, 3)$ -category, and let $F: X \rightarrow Y$ be a 1-morphism in C . The following are equivalent.*

- (i) *The morphism F admits a right adjoint $F^R: Y \rightarrow X$, and both*

$$\eta: \text{id}_X \rightarrow F^R F \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(X) \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon: F F^R \rightarrow \text{id}_Y \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(Y)$$

admit right adjoints (in the respective $(\infty, 2)$ -categories).

- (ii) *The morphism F admits a left adjoint $F^L: Y \rightarrow X$, and both*

$$\eta: \text{id}_X \rightarrow F F^L \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(X) \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon: F^L F \rightarrow \text{id}_Y \quad \text{in } \text{End}_C(Y)$$

admit left adjoints.

Moreover, when these conditions hold, there is a canonical identification $F^L \simeq F^R$.

Remark 2.8. There is a dual version of Proposition 2.7, in which the words “right” and “left” are swapped in (i) and (ii) respectively; it again yields a canonical identification $F^L \simeq F^R$. However, in any given application, η and ε must be assumed to admit the *same* type of adjoint for the result to apply.

Proof. We show that (i) implies (ii) with $F^L = F^R$; the dual implication is similar. Given (F^R, η, ε) as in (i), define

$$\eta' : \text{id}_X \rightarrow FF^R \quad \text{and} \quad \varepsilon' : F^R F \rightarrow \text{id}_Y$$

by $\eta' := \varepsilon^R$ and $\varepsilon' := \eta^R$. The triangle identities for $(F, F^R, \eta', \varepsilon')$ follow from those of $(F, F^R, \eta, \varepsilon)$ together with the fact that forming right adjoints is compatible with composition. By construction, η' and ε' admit left adjoints (namely ε and η themselves), giving (ii). $\square$

We now establish an ambidexterity property for the functors $f_{n,*}$.

Proposition 2.9. *Let $n \geq 1$, and let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a countably presented map in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Sp})$.*

- *The right adjoint $f_{n,*} : n\text{Pr}_B \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_A$ is also left adjoint to f_n^* . Moreover, it satisfies base change and the projection formula as a left adjoint.*
- *The category $n\text{Pr}_B$ is self-dual as an object of $(n+1)\text{Pr}_A \simeq \text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_A}(1\text{Pr})$.*

Proof. Since we have the adjunction $f_n^* \dashv f_{n,*}$, we obtain a unit and counit

$$\eta : \text{id} \rightarrow f_{n,*} f_n^* \in \text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_A}(n\text{Pr}_A) \quad \varepsilon : f_n^* f_{n,*} \rightarrow \text{id} \in \text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_A}(n\text{Pr}_B).$$

We will deduce the proposition from Proposition 2.7, applied in the $(\infty, 3)$ -category $\mathcal{C} = (n+1)\text{Pr}_A$ (which lies in $(n+2)\text{Pr}$ and hence in 3Pr , since $n \geq 1$); concretely, we need to verify that η and ε admit right adjoints. For η , note that evaluation at the unit induces an equivalence

$$\text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_A}(n\text{Pr}_A) \xrightarrow{\sim} n\text{Pr}_A.$$

Under this equivalence, the unit η corresponds to the map

$$f_{n-1}^* : (n-1)\text{Pr}_A \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}_B,$$

which indeed has a right adjoint $f_{n-1,*}$ in $n\text{Pr}_A$.

For ε , note that there is an equivalence

$$\begin{aligned} \text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_A}(1\text{Pr})(n\text{Pr}_B) &= \text{End}_{\text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_A}}(\text{Mod}_{(n-1)\text{Pr}_B}(n\text{Pr}_A), \text{Mod}_{(n-1)\text{Pr}_B}(n\text{Pr}_A)) \\ &\simeq \text{Mod}_{(n-1)\text{Pr}_B \otimes_{(n-1)\text{Pr}_A} (n-1)\text{Pr}_B}(n\text{Pr}_A). \end{aligned}$$

Under this equivalence, the counit ε corresponds to the ‘multiplication map’

$$(n-1)\text{Pr}_B \otimes_{(n-1)\text{Pr}_A} (n-1)\text{Pr}_B \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}_B.$$

The left-hand side is equivalent to $(n-1)\text{Pr}_{B \otimes_A B}$, and under this equivalence the map agrees with ∇_{n-1}^* induced by the codiagonal map $\nabla : B \otimes_A B \rightarrow B$. For this we also know it admits a $(n-1)\text{Pr}_{B \otimes_A B}$ -linear right adjoint.

For the claim about base change, we apply the same result inside the 3-category $\text{Ar}((n+1)\text{Pr}_A)$, the arrow category of $(n+1)\text{Pr}_A$. Since adjoints in this arrow category are precisely the adjointable squares, this gives the claim.

Finally, for the duality data on $n\text{Pr}_B$, we are using the following two maps:

$$\begin{aligned} n\text{Pr}_A &\xrightarrow{f_n^*} n\text{Pr}_B \xrightarrow{\nabla_{n,*}} n\text{Pr}_B \otimes_{n\text{Pr}_A} n\text{Pr}_B \\ n\text{Pr}_B \otimes_{n\text{Pr}_A} n\text{Pr}_B &\xrightarrow{\nabla_n^*} n\text{Pr}_B \xrightarrow{f_{n,*}} n\text{Pr}_A. \end{aligned}$$

The triangle identities are an immediate consequence of base change. □

3 Descent for quasicoherent sheaves

Talk given by Melvin.

We use the following output of the previous talk:

- For $A \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Sp})$, we defined categories $n\text{Pr}_A$ by

$$0\text{Pr}_A := \text{D}(A) := \text{Mod}_A(\text{Sp}), \quad (n+1)\text{Pr}_A := \text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_A}((n+1)\text{Pr}) \simeq \text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_A}(1\text{Pr}).$$

- The assignment $\text{Spec}(A) \mapsto n\text{Pr}_A$ defines a six-functor formalism on $\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ valued in 1Pr .
- For $n \geq 1$, we have ambidexterity: if $f: \text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(B)$ is countably presented, then the right adjoint $f_{n,*}: n\text{Pr}_A \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_B$ is also a left adjoint to f_n^* in a canonical way.

3.1 Hyperdescent

The goal of this chapter is the following hyperdescent statement:

Theorem 3.1. *The functor $n\text{Pr}_{(-)}^!: \text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}} \rightarrow 1\text{Pr}$ (defined on maps by the maps $f^!$) is a hypersheaf with respect to the fpqc topology for each $n \geq 0$. (Note that for $n \geq 1$, the maps $f^!$ agree with f^* by ambidexterity.)*

To make sense of this statement, we recall the following two definitions:

Definition 3.2. Let C be a site with finite limits. A *hypercover* of $A \in C$ is a simplicial object $A_{\bullet} \in \text{Fun}(\Delta^{\text{op}}, C)$ together with a map $A_0 \rightarrow A$ which is a cover in C , such that if we right Kan extend $A_{\bullet}$ to $A(-) \in \text{Fun}(\text{PSh}_{\text{fin}}(\Delta)^{\text{op}}, C)$, the map $A(\Delta^n) \rightarrow A(\partial\Delta^n)$ is a cover in C .

Definition 3.3. Recall the following basic definitions:

- For a static ring $B_0 \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Ab})$ and a static B_0 -module M_0 , we say that M_0 is *flat* if the functor $M_0 \otimes_{B_0} -: \text{Mod}_{B_0}(\text{Ab}) \rightarrow \text{Ab}$ is exact. It is called *faithfully flat* if, in addition, the functor $M_0 \otimes_{B_0} -$ is conservative, i.e. detects isomorphisms. (Equivalently it detects exact sequences.)
- A morphism $B_0 \rightarrow A_0$ in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Ab})$ is called *(faithfully) flat* if A_0 is (faithfully) flat as a B_0 -module.

- A morphism $B \rightarrow A$ in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Sp})$ is *(faithfully) flat* if the map $\pi_0 A \rightarrow \pi_0 B$ in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Ab})$ is (faithfully) flat and for each $i \in \mathbb{Z}$ the multiplication map $\pi_i B \otimes_{\pi_0 B} \pi_0 A \rightarrow \pi_i A$ is an isomorphism.
- A morphism $\text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(B)$ in $\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ is called (faithfully) flat if its associated map $B \rightarrow A$ in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Sp})$ is.

Definition 3.4. The *fpqc topology* on $\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ is the Grothendieck topology in which a sieve over $\text{Spec}(B)$ is declared to be a covering sieve if it contains a finite collection of morphisms $\text{Spec}(A_i) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(B)$ such that the induced map $\text{Spec}(\prod_{i=1}^n A_i) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(B)$ is faithfully flat.

Observe that a functor $F: \text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}^{\text{op}} \rightarrow C$ is a hypersheaf with respect to the fpqc topology if and only if the following two properties are satisfied:

- The functor F preserves finite products.
- For an fpqc hypercover $\text{Spec}(A_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$, the induced map

$$F(\text{Spec}(A)) \rightarrow \lim_{[n] \in \Delta} F(\text{Spec}(A_n))$$

is an isomorphism.

The proof has three parts:

- The main argument treats countably presented fpqc hypercovers; the final section reduces arbitrary fpqc hypercovers to this case.
- We first prove the theorem for $n = 0$.
- We then prove the general case by induction on n .

3.2 The base case $n = 0$

We will start by showing that the assignment $\text{Spec}(A) \mapsto D(A)$ satisfies fpqc-hyperdescent. Since we have $D(\prod_i A_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} \prod_i D(A_i)$, it remains to show that for an fpqc hypercover $\text{Spec}(A_{\bullet}) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$ in $\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ the functor

$$D(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_{\bullet})$$

is an equivalence. Here the limit on the right is taken along the functors $f^!$.

3.2.1 Step 1: Fully faithfulness

We start by showing that this comparison functor is fully faithful.

Note that the functor $D(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_{\bullet})$ admits a left adjoint, given by sending an object $(A_n)_{[n] \in \Delta}$ to the colimit $\text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta}^{\text{op}} (f_n)_* A_n$, where we denote by $f_n: \text{Spec}(A_n) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$ the maps constituting the hypercover. So we must show that for any object $M \in D(A)$, the counit map

$$\text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta}^{\text{op}} (f_n)_* f_n^! M \rightarrow M$$

is an isomorphism of A -modules. Note that we may rewrite the left-hand side as

$$\operatorname{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\operatorname{op}}} (f_n)_* f_n^! M = \operatorname{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\operatorname{op}}} (f_n)_* \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_{A_n}(A_n, f_n^! M) \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\operatorname{op}}} (f_n)_* \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(A_n, M).$$

We may now filter Δ by the subcategories $\Delta_{\leq n}$ to rewrite this colimit in turn as

$$\operatorname{colim}_{m \geq 0} \operatorname{colim}_{[n] \in (\Delta_{\leq m})^{\operatorname{op}}} \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(A_n, M) \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{m \geq 0} \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(\lim_{[n] \in \Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet, M),$$

where we use that a colimit over $\Delta_{\leq m}$ is a finite colimit and is thus preserved by the exact functor $\underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(-, M): \mathcal{D}(A) \rightarrow \mathcal{D}(A)$. If we similarly write $M \simeq \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(A, M) \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{m \geq 0} \underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(A, M)$, then the comparison map is obtained by applying $\underline{\operatorname{Hom}}_A(-, M)$ to the canonical map of pro-systems $A \rightarrow \{\lim_{\Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet\}_{m \geq 0}$ in $\mathcal{D}(A)$. So we need to show that this map is a pro-isomorphism in $\mathcal{D}(A)$.

Scholze now makes the following claim:

Claim 3.5. It suffices to show this after passing to connective covers.

During the seminar we did not manage to figure out why we may make this reduction step.

So, we will assume from now on that both A and all of the A_i are connective.

Now, to show that the map $A \rightarrow \{\lim_{\Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet\}_{m \geq 0}$ is an isomorphism in $\operatorname{Pro}(\mathcal{D}(A))$, we may equivalently show its cofiber is zero. The cofiber is given by the pro-system $\{C_m\}_{m \geq 0}$, where we set

$$C_m := \operatorname{cofib}(A \rightarrow \lim_{\Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet).$$

It will thus suffice to show that the map $C_{m+2} \rightarrow C_m$ is the zero map in $\mathcal{D}(A)$ for each $m \geq 0$. For this, recall the following definition:

Definition 3.6. A morphism $X \rightarrow Y$ in $\mathcal{D}(A)$ is called a *phantom map* if the induced map $\pi_i(X) \rightarrow \pi_i(Y)$ is the zero map for each $i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Equivalently, for every perfect A -module Z and every map $Z \rightarrow X$, the composite $Z \rightarrow X \rightarrow Y$ is nullhomotopic.

Observation 3.7. Every A -module X may be written as a filtered colimit of perfect A -modules: simply consider the collection of maps $\{X' \rightarrow X\}$ with X' perfect. If we write $X = \operatorname{colim}_{i \in I} X_i$, then we see that a map $X \rightarrow Y$ is phantom if and only if it lies in the kernel of the map

$$\pi_0(\lim_i \operatorname{hom}_A(X_i, Y)) \cong \pi_0 \operatorname{hom}_A(X, Y) \rightarrow \lim_i \pi_0 \operatorname{hom}_A(X_i, Y).$$

This kernel is $\lim_i^1 \pi_{-1} \operatorname{hom}_A(X_i, Y)$.

Lemma 3.8. *The composite of two phantom maps is nullhomotopic.*

Proof sketch. Consider two phantom maps $W \rightarrow X \rightarrow Y$. By the above observation, both maps come from $\lim^1$ -terms. Their composite would then be an element of some $\lim^2$. But $\lim^2$ of abelian groups are zero. $\square$

In light of the lemma, it remains to show that each map $C_{m+1} \rightarrow C_m$ is a phantom map. We now make the following claim:

Claim 3.9. For each $m \geq 0$, the A -module $C_m := \operatorname{cofib}(A \rightarrow \lim_{\Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet)$ is a countably generated flat A -module in degree $m - 1$, i.e. $C_m[-(m - 1)]$ is a flat A -module.

We will prove this claim below, but let us first explain why it implies that $C_{m+1} \rightarrow C_m$ is phantom. For this, recall the following spectral analogue of Lazard's theorem:

Theorem 3.10 (Lazard, HA 7.2.2.15). *Let A be a connective ring spectrum. Then every connective countably presented flat A -module M is a sequential colimit of finite rank free A -modules:*

$$M \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{i \geq 0} A^{\oplus n_i}.$$

Combining this with Claim 3.9, we may thus write $C_{m+1} \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{i \geq 0} A^{\oplus n_i}[-m]$. Now, if Z is any perfect A -module and $Z \rightarrow C_{m+1}$ is any map, then it must factor through some finite stage $Z \rightarrow A^{\oplus n_i}[-m]$. So it suffices to show that any map $A[-m] \rightarrow C_m$ is nullhomotopic in $D(A)$. But homotopy classes of such maps correspond to elements of $\pi_{-m}(C_m)$, which is 0 since by Claim 3.9 C_m is concentrated in degree $m - 1$.

We now move towards a proof of Claim 3.9. For this, recall that an A -module M is flat if and only if $M \otimes_A \pi_0(A)$ is a flat static $\pi_0 A$ -module. So we may check the claim after base changing to $\pi_0 A$. Observe that base change commutes with the cofiber and with the finite limit $\lim_{\leq m} A_\bullet$. So we may assume that A and $A_\bullet$ are static.

The augmented cosimplicial object $\{A_\bullet\}$ may be turned into a cochain complex

$$A \rightarrow A_0 \rightarrow A_1 \rightarrow \dots$$

by taking the alternating sums of the face maps (the unreduced version of Dold–Kan). We claim that this is an exact sequence. We may test this after base change along faithfully flat maps $A \rightarrow B$. Since our cosimplicial object is an fpqc hypercover, we may then base change to objects after which the sequence becomes split, hence exact. Details are omitted here.

It then follows (why?) that

$$C_m = \operatorname{cofib}(A \rightarrow \lim_{\Delta_{\leq m}} A_\bullet) \simeq \operatorname{coker}(A_{m-1} \rightarrow A_m)[m - 1].$$

Thus, Claim 3.9 reduces to the claim that $\operatorname{coker}(A_{m-1} \rightarrow A_m)$ is a countably generated static flat A -module.

Scholze says the following about this: “Moreover, the same holds true after any base change in A , in particular along a quotient map $A \rightarrow A/I$; this shows that this cokernel is flat over A .”

All in all, we have now proved the fully faithfulness of the functor $D(A) \rightarrow \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_n)$.

3.2.2 Step 2: Essential surjectivity

We now show the functor $D(A) \rightarrow \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_n)$ is an equivalence.

Step 2a) We first reduce to the case where $A_\bullet$ is a Čech cover. To this end, consider the following commutative square:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \longrightarrow & A_i \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ A_0 & \longrightarrow & A_0 \otimes_A A_i. \end{array}$$

Since the cosimplicial object at the bottom is split, we have

$$D(A_0) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[i] \in \Delta}^! D(A_0 \otimes_A A_i),$$

and similarly $D(A_0^{\otimes A^n}) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[i] \in \Delta}^! D(A_0^{\otimes A^n} \otimes_A A_i)$ for all $n \geq 0$. So we are done if we can show that

$$D(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_0^{\otimes A^n}) \quad \text{and} \quad D(A_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_0^{\otimes A^n} \otimes_A A_i),$$

which is the special case of Čech descent.

Step 2b) Assume now that $A_i \cong A_0^{\otimes A^i}$ is the Čech cover of $A \rightarrow A_0$. To show that the map $D(A) \rightarrow \lim_{[n] \in \Delta}^! D(A_n)$ is an isomorphism in Pr^R , we may pass to left adjoints and show that

$$\text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\text{op}}} D(A_n) \rightarrow D(A)$$

is an isomorphism in Pr^L . Here the colimit is taken along the functors $(f_n)_*: D(A_n) \rightarrow D(A)$. Recall that each of these functors lives in $\text{Pr}_{D(A)} = \text{Mod}_{D(A)}(\text{Pr})$, and hence the colimit may be computed in $\text{Mod}_{D(A)}(\text{Pr})$. Also note that if we apply the functor $D(A_0) \otimes_{D(A)} -: \text{Mod}_{D(A)}(\text{Pr}) \rightarrow \text{Mod}_{D(A_0)}(\text{Pr})$, the augmented simplicial diagram admits a splitting, since $D(A_0) \otimes_{D(A)} D(A_n) \cong D(A_{n+1})$. It follows that the map $\text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\text{op}}} D(A_n) \rightarrow D(A)$ becomes an isomorphism after applying $D(A_i) \otimes_{D(A)} -$ for each i , and thus by passing to colimits also after applying $(\text{colim}_i D(A_i)) \otimes_{D(A)} -$.

Now, by Step 1 we know that the functor $D(A) \rightarrow \lim_{\Delta}^! D(A_\bullet) \simeq \text{colim}_* D(A_\bullet)$ is fully faithful. In particular, if we denote the image of the monoidal unit $\mathbb{1} \in D(A)$ by M , then we see that M is sent to $\mathbb{1}$ under the $D(A)$ -linear left adjoint $\text{colim}_* D(A_\bullet)$. If we consider the $D(A)$ -linear functor $D(A) \rightarrow \text{colim}_* D(A_\bullet)$ determined by M , it thus follows that the composite

$$D(A) \rightarrow \text{colim}_* D(A_\bullet) \rightarrow D(A)$$

is the identity in $\text{Pr}_{D(A)}$, showing that $D(A)$ is a retract of this colimit. It thus follows that the map $\text{colim}_{[n] \in \Delta^{\text{op}}} D(A_n) \rightarrow D(A)$ becomes an isomorphism after applying $D(A) \otimes_{D(A)} -$. Since this is the identity functor, we are done.

This finishes the proof in the countably presented case, for $n = 0$.

3.3 The induction step for $n > 0$

We now assume that $n > 0$, and that we have already proved the claim for $n - 1$. Observe that we again have an adjunction

$$F_n^*: n\text{Pr}_A \rightleftarrows \lim n\text{Pr}_{A_\bullet}: F_{n,\#}.$$

Also, in this case each of the individual adjunctions $n\text{Pr}_A \rightleftarrows n\text{Pr}_{A_\bullet}$ is an ambidextrous adjunction.

We first show that F_n^* is fully faithful, or equivalently that the counit map

$$F_{n,\#} F_n^* \rightarrow \text{id}$$

is an isomorphism. Note that this adjunction is $n\text{Pr}_A$ -linear, so it suffices to show this claim on the monoidal unit: we need to show that the map $F_{n,\#} F_n^*(n-1)\text{Pr}_A \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}_A$ is an equivalence.

For $n = 1$, this map is $F_{1,\#} F_1^* D(A) \xrightarrow{\sim} D(A)$, which is the base case we just showed.

For $n \geq 2$, we need to show that $F_{n,\#} F_n^*(n-1)\text{Pr}_A \xrightarrow{\sim} (n-1)\text{Pr}_A$. One can show that the LHS is dualizable, so we may equivalently show that the dual map $(n-1)\text{Pr}_A \rightarrow F_{n,\#} F_n^*(n-1)\text{Pr}_A$ is an

isomorphism. But this is a linear map, so it agrees with the map one level lower. This concludes the induction.

Essential surjectivity is proved similarly to the previous situation, by reducing to the Čech-cover. (It's even a bit easier, as we have ambidexterity.)

This finishes the proof.

3.4 Reduction to the countably presented case

Finally, we show that the claim for $n = 0$ can be reduced to the countably presented case. We use the following lemma:

Lemma 3.11. *Every faithfully flat map $A \rightarrow B$ of commutative ring spectra is an $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimit of countably presented such maps.*

The proof is omitted; we refer to Scholze's notes.

As a consequence, every fpqc hypercover is an $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimit of countably presented fpqc hypercovers.

Now, given any hypercover $\mathrm{Spec}(A_\bullet) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, we have

$$\lim_{\Delta}^! n\mathrm{Pr}_{A_\bullet} \simeq \lim_{\Delta}^! \mathrm{colim}_r n\mathrm{Pr}_{A_{r,\bullet}} \simeq \mathrm{colim}_r \lim_{\Delta}^! n\mathrm{Pr}_{A_{r,\bullet}} \simeq n\mathrm{Pr}_A,$$

where we use that $1\mathrm{Pr}$ is $\aleph_1$ -compactly generated so that $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits commute with countable limits. This finishes the proof of the general form of the theorem.

4 Quasicoherent sheaves of higher categories II

Talk given by Bastiaan.

We now pass from affine spectral schemes ($\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}} := \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})^{\mathrm{op}}$) to fpqc-stacks.

On affines, Talk 2 introduced the functors

$$\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}((n+1)\mathrm{Pr}) = \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/}, \quad \mathrm{Spec}(A) \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_A$$

for all $n \geq 0$, and showed they canonically extend to six-functor formalisms in which every countably presented map is cohomologically proper. Denote by

$$\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}) \subseteq \mathrm{PSh}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})$$

the subcategory of *small* fpqc-sheaves. Here *small* means that the sheaf is a small colimit of representable objects. (In fact, we will mostly restrict to sheaves which are countable colimits of affines.) By the main result of Talk 3, we obtain a unique limit-preserving extension

$$\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/}, \quad X \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_X.$$

Since the endomorphism functor $\mathrm{End} : (n+1)\mathrm{Pr} \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}$ commutes with limits, this means that every fpqc-stack X defines a Stefanich ring

$$(O(X), D(X), 1\mathrm{Pr}_X, 2\mathrm{Pr}_X, \dots),$$

giving rise to a functor $\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathrm{StRing}$.

For $n = 0$, the value $0\mathrm{Pr}_X = D(X)$ is the usual derived ∞ -category of quasicoherent sheaves on X , at least when X is a countable colimit of affines.

Remark 4.1. In general, there is a difference between taking the limit defining $n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ inside $1\mathrm{Pr} = \mathrm{Pr}_{\mathbb{N}_1}^{\mathrm{L}}$ or inside the larger category Pr^{L} of all presentable categories. Usually, $\mathrm{QCoh}(X)$ is defined using limits in Pr^{L} . For countable colimits of affines the two limits agree.

The rest of the chapter has four goals:

- For $n \geq 1$, we extend the assignment $X \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ to a six-functor formalism, with $!$ -able maps given by so-called ‘bi-countably presented maps’;

- We show that “every bi-countably presented map is étale”, and for $n \geq 2$ that in fact “every bi-countably presented map is proper”;
- We deduce a Künneth formula for sheaves of $(n-1)$ -presentable categories on a fiber product;
- We conclude that the Stefanich ring functor preserves countable colimits and finite limits.

4.1 Bi-countably presented maps

We will now extend the assignment $X \mapsto n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ to a six-functor formalism. We may think of this as a ‘higher’ version of the six-functor formalism on $X \mapsto D(X)$. A first question is: what are the !-able maps? It turns out that at the higher categorical level, the class of !-able maps contains essentially *all* maps. The relevant class of maps is the following:

Definition 4.2. Let $A \in \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$. A map $Z \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ of fpqc sheaves is *bi-countably presented over $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$* if Z is a countable colimit, in $\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}/\mathrm{Spec}(A))$, of affines $\mathrm{Spec}(B_i)$ with $A \rightarrow B_i$ countably presented.

A map $f: Y \rightarrow X$ of fpqc stacks is *bi-countably presented* if for every affine $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \rightarrow X$, the fiber product $Y \times_X \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is bi-countably presented over $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$. Let E denote the class of bi-countably presented maps.

We first record the affine algebra input that will be used below.

Lemma 4.3. *Let $A \in \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Sp})$.*

- (i) *Countably presented A -algebras are closed under countable colimits, retracts, and finite colimits in $\mathrm{CAlg}_A(\mathrm{Sp})$.*
- (ii) *Countably presented maps of affine spectral schemes are stable under base change and composition.*
- (iii) *If $A \rightarrow B$ and $A \rightarrow C$ are countably presented and $B \rightarrow C$ is a map over A , then $B \rightarrow C$ is countably presented.*
- (iv) *If $\mathrm{Spec}(B) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is countably presented and admits a section $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(B)$, then the section is countably presented.*

Proof. Part (i) is Lemma A.4(1), applied with $\kappa = \aleph_1$ and $C = \mathrm{Sp}$.

For base change in (ii), suppose $A \rightarrow B$ is countably presented and $A \rightarrow A'$ is any map. The base change is $\mathrm{Spec}(A' \otimes_A B) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A')$, and $A' \rightarrow A' \otimes_A B$ is countably presented by Lemma A.4(2). For composition, if $A \rightarrow B$ and $B \rightarrow C$ are countably presented, then $A \rightarrow C$ is countably presented by Lemma A.4(3).

Part (iii) is Lemma A.4(4). Finally, a section $\mathrm{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(B)$ corresponds to an A -algebra retraction $B \rightarrow A$, so (iv) is exactly Lemma A.5. $\square$

Lemma 4.4. *Let $S = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, and let $p: Z \rightarrow S$ be bi-countably presented. Then every section $s: S \rightarrow Z$ of p is bi-countably presented as a map to Z .*

Proof. We first record two elementary fpqc-local reductions. Let $S' = \operatorname{Spec}(A') \rightarrow S = \operatorname{Spec}(A)$ be faithfully flat and countably presented. A map $W \rightarrow S$ is bi-countably presented if and only if its base change $W_{S'} \rightarrow S'$ is bi-countably presented. The forward implication is base change. Conversely, write $S'_\bullet$ for the Čech nerve of $S' \rightarrow S$. Since $A \rightarrow A'$ is countably presented, each $S'_m \rightarrow S$ is countably presented by Lemma 4.3. If $W_{S'}$ is a countable colimit of affines countably presented over S' , then each $W_{S'_m}$ is a countable colimit of affines countably presented over S . By fpqc descent,

$$W \simeq |W_{S'_\bullet}|,$$

and the indexing category Δ^{op} is countable. Hence W is again a countable colimit of affines countably presented over S .

Second, let

$$Z \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{i \in I} \operatorname{Spec}(B_i)$$

be a countable affine presentation over S , and let $T = \operatorname{Spec}(C) \rightarrow S$ be affine. Any finite collection of sections $T \rightarrow Z_T := Z \times_S T$ factors, after a faithfully flat countably presented base change $T' \rightarrow T$, through stages of the induced presentation

$$Z_T \simeq \operatorname{colim}_{i \in I} \operatorname{Spec}(B_i \otimes_A C).$$

Indeed, by the definition of sheafification, this factorization exists after some fpqc cover of T . By Lemma 3.11, and because the stages are countably presented over T , this cover can be refined by a faithfully flat countably presented affine cover. For finitely many sections we take a common refinement.

We now prove the lemma. Let $T = \operatorname{Spec}(C) \rightarrow Z$ be an affine test object. We must show that

$$T \times_Z S \rightarrow T$$

is bi-countably presented. After base change along $T \rightarrow S$, the map $Z_T \rightarrow T$ has two sections: the section t induced by the given map $T \rightarrow Z$, and the section s_T obtained by pulling back s . By the fpqc-local reductions above, we may pass to a faithfully flat countably presented cover of T and assume that both sections factor through stages of a countable presentation of Z_T .

Let $\operatorname{Aff}_T^{\text{cp}}$ be the full subcategory of affine T -schemes which are countably presented over T . It has finite limits by Lemma 4.3. Let $\widetilde{Z}$ be the corresponding countable colimit of representables in $\operatorname{PSh}(\operatorname{Aff}_T^{\text{cp}})$. The two sections $s_T, t: T \rightarrow Z_T$ now come from maps

$$* \rightrightarrows \widetilde{Z}$$

in this presheaf category, where $*$ denotes the terminal representable. Consider the presheaf fiber product

$$P := * \times_{\widetilde{Z}} *.$$

The objects $*$ and $\widetilde{Z}$ are $\aleph_1$ -compact in $\operatorname{PSh}(\operatorname{Aff}_T^{\text{cp}})$, and Proposition A.9 shows that P is again $\aleph_1$ -compact. Since presheaf categories are generated by representables, P is a countable colimit of representables from $\operatorname{Aff}_T^{\text{cp}}$. Sheafification preserves finite limits, so the sheafification of P is precisely

$$T \times_{Z_T} T \simeq T \times_Z S.$$

Thus, fpqc locally on T , the map $T \times_Z S \rightarrow T$ is bi-countably presented. The first reduction descends this conclusion to T itself. $\square$

Proposition 4.5. *The class E is closed under composition, base change, sections, and formation of diagonals.*

Proof. Closure under base change is immediate from the definition. For closure under composition, let $Z \rightarrow Y \rightarrow X$ be two maps in E and let $\text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow X$ be affine. Write

$$Y_A := Y \times_X \text{Spec}(A) \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} \text{Spec}(B_i),$$

where I is countable and each $A \rightarrow B_i$ is countably presented. By base change, $Z_A \rightarrow Y_A$ is bi-countably presented. Applying the definition of bi-countably presented to the affine test objects $\text{Spec}(B_i) \rightarrow Y_A$, each

$$Z_A \times_{Y_A} \text{Spec}(B_i)$$

is a countable colimit of affines $\text{Spec}(C_{i,k})$ with $B_i \rightarrow C_{i,k}$ countably presented. Since countably presented maps are closed under composition, each $A \rightarrow C_{i,k}$ is countably presented. Universality of colimits in sheaves gives

$$Z_A \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} (Z_A \times_{Y_A} \text{Spec}(B_i)) \simeq \text{colim}_{(i,k)} \text{Spec}(C_{i,k}),$$

and the final indexing category is still countable. Hence $Z \rightarrow X$ lies in E .

It remains to discuss sections and diagonals. The diagonal $\Delta_f: Y \rightarrow Y \times_X Y$ is a section of the first projection

$$Y \times_X Y \rightarrow Y.$$

This projection is a base change of f , hence lies in E . Since E is already closed under base change, it is therefore enough to know that E is closed under sections.

Let $p: Y \rightarrow X$ lie in E , let $s: X \rightarrow Y$ be a section, and test s against an affine map $a: \text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow Y$. Base change p along the composite $\text{Spec}(A) \xrightarrow{a} Y \xrightarrow{p} X$. Since $p \in E$, the resulting map $Y_A := Y \times_X \text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$ is bi-countably presented over $\text{Spec}(A)$. The map a gives one section of $Y_A \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$, and $s \circ p \circ a$ gives another. Moreover

$$X \times_Y \text{Spec}(A) \simeq \text{Spec}(A) \times_{Y_A} \text{Spec}(A)$$

with respect to these two sections. By Lemma 4.4, the first section $\text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow Y_A$ is bi-countably presented as a map to Y_A . Pulling it back along the second section shows that

$$\text{Spec}(A) \times_{Y_A} \text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$$

is bi-countably presented over $\text{Spec}(A)$. Thus $s \in E$, so E is closed under sections and therefore under diagonals. $\square$

4.2 A six-functor formalism for $n\text{Pr}$ at $n \geq 1$

We fix $n \geq 1$. Given a map $f: Y \rightarrow X$ of fpqc-stacks, we denote the resulting symmetric monoidal pullback functor by

$$f_n^*: n\text{Pr}_X \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_Y,$$

and its right adjoint by f_{n*} . We denote by $\otimes_{n\text{Pr}_X}$ the tensor product of $n\text{Pr}_X$.

Remark 4.6. Throughout this talk, we will frequently abuse notation and regard $n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$ as an object of $(n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_X$ by setting

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_Y := f_{n+1,*}(\mathbb{1}_Y) \in (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_X.$$

For $p_X : X \rightarrow \mathrm{pt}$, we get a ‘forgetful functor’ $p_{X,n+1,*} : (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_X \rightarrow (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}$, and we claim that the image of $f_{n+1,*}(\mathbb{1}_Y)$ under this functor is $n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$. Indeed, if we write $Y \simeq \mathrm{colim}_{\mathrm{Spec}(A) \rightarrow Y} \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, then we may write $p_{X,n+1,*}f_{n+1,*}(\mathbb{1}) = p_{Y,n+1,*}(\mathbb{1})$ as a limit over $p_{A,n+1}(\mathbb{1}) = n\mathrm{Pr}_A$, which is $n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$ by definition.

Theorem 4.7. *Let $f : Y \rightarrow X$ be a bi-countably presented map of fpqc stacks, and let $n \geq 1$.*

(i) *The functor*

$$f_n^* : n\mathrm{Pr}_X \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$$

admits a left adjoint $f_{n,\#}$ in $(n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_X$. In particular, $f_{n,\#}$ commutes with all small colimits and with tensoring.

(ii) *The object $n\mathrm{Pr}_Y \in (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}_X$ is $\aleph_1$ -compact.*

(iii) *The formation of $f_{n,\#}$ commutes with base change: for every cartesian square*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y' & \xrightarrow{v} & Y \\ f' \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ X' & \xrightarrow{u} & X \end{array}$$

the Beck-Chevalley transformation

$$u_n^* f_{n,\#} \rightarrow f'_{n,\#} v_n^*$$

is an equivalence.

(iv) *For $n \geq 2$, the object $f_{n,\#}(\mathbb{1}) \in n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ is dualizable.*

(v) *For $n \geq 2$, the left adjoint $f_{n,\#}$ is also right adjoint to f_n^* , i.e. $f_{n,\#} \simeq f_{n,*}$. In particular, $f_{n,*}$ also commutes with small colimits, tensoring, and base change.*

In other words: at level $n \geq 1$, “all maps are étale”, and at level $n \geq 2$, “all maps are proper”.

Proof. Step 1: The affine case. We first assume that $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$ is affine and prove (i)-(iv). By assumption $Y = \mathrm{colim}_{i \in I} \mathrm{Spec}(B_i)$ is a countable colimit of affines $Y_i = \mathrm{Spec}(B_i)$, where each B_i is countably presented over A . Consider

$$f_n^* : n\mathrm{Pr}_X = n\mathrm{Pr}_A \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_Y = \lim_{i \in I^{\mathrm{op}}} n\mathrm{Pr}_{B_i}.$$

Since $n \geq 1$ and all transition maps are countably presented, the result from Talk 2 shows that all the pullback functors involved admit linear left adjoints. In particular, the limit defining $n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$ is along right adjoints, and hence agrees with the colimit along the corresponding left adjoints:

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_Y \simeq \mathrm{colim}_{i \in I, \#} n\mathrm{Pr}_{B_i}.$$

(We use countability of I here so that this colimit takes place inside the $\aleph_1$ -presentable setting 1Pr .) In this colimit description, the desired left adjoint is given as the colimit of the lower- $\sharp$ maps $n\text{Pr}_{B_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_A$:

$$f_{n,\sharp} : n\text{Pr}_Y \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I, \sharp} n\text{Pr}_{B_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_A.$$

(See Horev and Yanovski [HY17, Corollary 1.3].) This is a map in $(n+1)\text{Pr}_A = \text{Mod}_{n\text{Pr}_A}(1\text{Pr})$, and in particular it commutes with all small colimits and with tensoring. This gives (i). We may explicitly write the resulting functor as

$$f_{n,\sharp} : \lim_{i \in I, \text{op}} n\text{Pr}_{B_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_A, \quad (Z_i) \mapsto \text{colim}_{i \in I} (g_i)_{n,\sharp}(Z_i),$$

with $g_i : \text{Spec}(B_i) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$ the affine structure map.

For (ii), since $\aleph_1$ -compact objects in $(n+1)\text{Pr}_A$ are closed under countable colimits, the $\aleph_1$ -compactness of $n\text{Pr}_Y$ follows from the $\aleph_1$ -compactness of the $n\text{Pr}_{B_i}$ established in Talk 2.

For (iii), let $A \rightarrow A'$ be a base change, and write $B'_i := B_i \otimes_A A'$ and $Y' := Y \times_{\text{Spec}(A)} \text{Spec}(A')$. Since colimits in sheaves are universal,

$$Y' \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} \text{Spec}(B'_i).$$

Hence the same construction applied over A' gives

$$f'_{n,\sharp} : n\text{Pr}_{Y'} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_{A'}, \quad (Z'_i) \mapsto \text{colim}_{i \in I} (g'_i)_{n,\sharp}(Z'_i),$$

where $g'_i : \text{Spec}(B'_i) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A')$ is the base change of $g_i : \text{Spec}(B_i) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(A)$. The base-change property is known from Talk 2:

$$u_n^*(g_i)_{n,\sharp} \simeq (g'_i)_{n,\sharp}(v_i)_n^*.$$

Thus base change carries the diagram whose colimit defines $f_{n,\sharp}$ to the diagram whose colimit defines $f'_{n,\sharp}$. Since the indexing category I is countable, this colimit is taken inside 1Pr , and we obtain the desired Beck-Chevalley equivalence

$$u_n^* f_{n,\sharp} \simeq f'_{n,\sharp} v_n^*.$$

For (iv), we evaluate at the unit. In the affine case, we have $(g_i)_{n,\sharp} = (g_i)_{n,*}$ by ambidexterity from Talk 2, so

$$f_{n,\sharp}(1) \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} (g_i)_{n,*}(1) \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I, *} (n-1)\text{Pr}_{B_i},$$

where the colimit is along the lower- $*$ functors. For $n \geq 2$ (so that $n-1 \geq 1$), the lower- $*$ functors $(n-1)\text{Pr}_{B_i} \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}_{B_j}$ are themselves linear left adjoints. Hence the colimit above is a countable colimit of dualizable objects along internal left adjoint functors. Such a colimit is itself dualizable, by the following more general result:

Claim: For $\mathcal{V} \in \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})$, countable colimits of dualizable objects along internal left adjoints in $\text{Pr}_{\mathcal{V}}$ are again dualizable.

This is a result by Ramzi. In short, the reason is that the dualizable objects can be characterized as those C that are retracts of $\mathcal{P}_{\mathcal{V}}(C^{\aleph_1})$ in a canonical way. Since this retract diagram is functorial in C , it shows closure under countable colimits.

Step 2: The general case. For general X , we may write X as a colimit of affine spectral schemes, providing an equivalence

$$(n+1)\text{Pr}_X \simeq \lim_{\text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow X} (n+1)\text{Pr}_A.$$

This is a limit in $1\text{Pr} = \text{Pr}_{\aleph_1}^L \simeq \text{Rex}_{\aleph_1}$, so on the level of underlying $(\infty, 1)$ -categories we have

$$((n+1)\text{Pr}_X)^{\aleph_1} = \lim_{\text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow X} ((n+1)\text{Pr}_A)^{\aleph_1}.$$

Letting $Y_A := \text{Spec}(A) \times_X Y$, we have already established that $n\text{Pr}_{Y_A}$ is $\aleph_1$ -compact in $(n+1)\text{Pr}_A$, thus giving the $\aleph_1$ -compactness of $n\text{Pr}_Y$ in $(n+1)\text{Pr}_X$. Moreover, to check that $f_n^*: n\text{Pr}_X \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_Y$ admits a left adjoint in $((n+1)\text{Pr}_X)^{\aleph_1}$, it will suffice to show that all maps $(f_A)_n^*: n\text{Pr}_A \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_{Y_A}$ admit a left adjoints compatible with base change, which we established in Step 1. Similarly, the dualizability of $f_{n,\#}(\mathbb{1}) \in n\text{Pr}_X$ may be checked after pullback to affines.

Step 3: Ambidexterity. For (v), we use the general ambidexterity result again: it suffices to check that the unit and counit of the adjunction $f_n^* \dashv f_{n,\#}$ admit right adjoints. For the counit $f_{n,\#} f_n^* \rightarrow \text{id}$, we use that under the equivalence $\text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_X}(n\text{Pr}_X, n\text{Pr}_X) \simeq n\text{Pr}_X$ this map corresponds to the map $f_{n,\#}(\mathbb{1}) \rightarrow \mathbb{1}$, so we need to show this admits a right adjoint in $n\text{Pr}_X$. By (iv), the object $f_{n,\#}(\mathbb{1})$ is dualizable, so this is equivalent to its dual $\mathbb{1} \rightarrow f_{n,*}(\mathbb{1})$ admitting a left adjoint in $n\text{Pr}_X$. But this dual map is the map $(n-1)\text{Pr}_X \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}_Y$, which has a left adjoint in $n\text{Pr}_X$ by part (i) applied one level down (which uses $n-1 \geq 1$).

For the unit $\eta: \text{id} \rightarrow f_n^* f_{n,\#}$ in $\text{End}_{(n+1)\text{Pr}_X}(n\text{Pr}_Y, n\text{Pr}_Y)$ we use a base-change argument. Consider the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y \times_X Y & \xrightarrow{p_2} & Y \\ p_1 \downarrow & & \downarrow f \\ Y & \xrightarrow{f} & X \end{array}$$

together with the diagonal $\delta: Y \rightarrow Y \times_X Y$. Since the class E is closed under formation of diagonals, δ is bi-countably presented, so the conclusions of parts (i)–(iv) are available for δ at level n . By base change (part (iii)), there is a canonical equivalence

$$f_n^* f_{n,\#} \simeq p_{1,n,\#} p_{2,n}^*.$$

The level- n counit $\varepsilon_\delta: \delta_{n,\#} \delta_n^* \rightarrow \text{id}_{n\text{Pr}_{Y \times_X Y}}$ of $\delta_{n,\#} \dashv \delta_n^*$ then induces a 2-morphism

$$p_{1,n,\#} \varepsilon_\delta p_{2,n}^*: \text{id}_{n\text{Pr}_Y} = p_{1,n,\#} \delta_{n,\#} \delta_n^* p_{2,n}^* \rightarrow p_{1,n,\#} p_{2,n}^* \simeq f_n^* f_{n,\#}.$$

This 2-morphism agrees with the unit η_f , which one verifies by checking that together with ε_f it satisfies the triangle identities (a consequence of base change). But since we already showed that the counit ε_δ is a left adjoint and whiskering with the functors $p_{1,n,\#}$ and $p_{2,n}^*$ preserves adjunctions, this finishes the proof. $\square$

4.3 The Künneth formula

As a consequence of the theorem, we obtain the following Künneth formula:

Corollary 4.8. *Let $f: Y \rightarrow X$ and $f': Y' \rightarrow X$ be bi-countably presented maps, and let $n \geq 2$. Then the objects $(n-1)\text{Pr}_Y$ and $(n-1)\text{Pr}_{Y'}$ in $n\text{Pr}_X$ are dualizable, and the Künneth formula*

$$(n-1)\text{Pr}_Y \otimes_{n\text{Pr}_X} (n-1)\text{Pr}_{Y'} \xrightarrow{\sim} (n-1)\text{Pr}_{Y \times_X Y'}$$

holds, where the equivalence is implemented via the external tensor product.

Proof. By definition, $(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_Y$ as an object of $n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ is $f_{n,*}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y})$. Since $n \geq 2$, Theorem 4.7 gives ambidexterity $f_{n,*} \simeq f_{n,\sharp}$, and hence

$$(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_Y \simeq f_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y}).$$

The same theorem then implies that this object is dualizable in $n\mathrm{Pr}_X$; similarly for Y' .

For the Künneth formula, write $Z := Y \times_X Y'$, with projections

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Z & \xrightarrow{q} & Y' \\ p \downarrow & & \downarrow f' \\ Y & \xrightarrow{f} & X. \end{array}$$

The maps p , q , and $f \circ p = f' \circ q$ are again bi-countably presented by Proposition 4.5, so the relevant $\sharp$ -functors are available. Using the projection formula for $f_{n,\sharp}$, base change for the cartesian square above, and then the projection formula for $p_{n,\sharp}$, we then compute

$$\begin{aligned} (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_Y \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_X} (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'} &\simeq f_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y}) \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_X} f'_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}}) \\ &\simeq f_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y} \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y} f_n^* f'_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}})) \\ &\simeq f_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y} \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y} p_{n,\sharp} q_n^*(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}})) \\ &\simeq f_{n,\sharp} p_{n,\sharp} (p_n^*(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Y}) \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Z} q_n^*(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}})) \\ &\simeq (f \circ p)_{n,\sharp}(\mathbb{1}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_Z}) \\ &\simeq (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_Z. \end{aligned}$$

In the penultimate line we used that pullback preserves monoidal units. Since $Z = Y \times_X Y'$, this is the desired equivalence. $\square$

In particular, for $n \geq 2$, sheaves of presentable $(n-1)$ -categories on a fiber product are determined by what they are on the factors and what sheaves of presentable n -categories are on the base. This is the first genuinely surprising statement about quasicohherent sheaves of higher categories: *both* parts of Corollary 4.8 fail at lower categorical levels:

- At level $n = 0$, it would say that $\mathcal{O}(Y) \in \mathrm{D}(X)$ is dualizable (i.e. a perfect complex), or that $\mathcal{O}(Y) \otimes_{\mathrm{D}(X)} \mathcal{O}(Y') \simeq \mathcal{O}(Y \times_X Y')$, both of which are absurd without strong assumptions on Y and Y' .
- At level $n = 1$, it is often the case that $\mathrm{D}(Y) \in 1\mathrm{Pr}_X$ is dualizable and the Künneth formula holds (cf. work by Gaitsgory), but one still needs some assumption such as “ Y is a geometric stack over X ”.
- For $n \geq 2$, these results are essentially *always* true.

However, we cannot stay on a fixed categorical level (say $1\mathrm{Pr}$): the Künneth formula always uses the next categorical level on the base X .

4.4 Dropping the bi-countable-presentation hypothesis

We will now see that for some of the previous assertions we may drop the condition on the map being bi-countably presented if instead we require sufficient compactness conditions on X and Y .

Proposition 4.9. *Let $f: Y \rightarrow X$ be a map between $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects of $\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})$ (so both X and Y are countable colimits of affine spectral schemes by Lemma 4.11 below). For $n \geq 2$, the right adjoint*

$$f_{n,*}: n\mathrm{Pr}_Y \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_X$$

of f_n^ admits a further right adjoint in $\mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_X}(\mathrm{Pr}^{\mathrm{L}})$, which is compatible with base change. Moreover, for any $f': Y' \rightarrow X$ satisfying the same hypothesis, the Künneth formula*

$$(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_Y \otimes_{n\mathrm{Pr}_X} (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'} \simeq (n-1)\mathrm{Pr}_{Y \times_X Y'}$$

holds.

Remark 4.10. If X is affine, the conclusion says that $f_{n,*}$ is a map in $\mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_A}(\mathrm{Pr}^{\mathrm{L}})$, but *not* in general in $\mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_A}(\mathrm{Pr}_{\mathfrak{N}_1}^{\mathrm{L}}) = \mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}_A}(1\mathrm{Pr})$: it fails only to preserve $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects.

The proof of the proposition requires various auxiliary lemmas, which will be given after the proof of the proposition.

Proof. We first reduce to the case where X is affine. Since X is $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact, by Lemma 4.11 it is a countable colimit of affines,

$$X \simeq \mathrm{colim}_j \mathrm{Spec}(A_j).$$

By Lemma 4.11, $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects of $\mathrm{Shv}_{\mathrm{fpqc}}(\mathrm{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})$ are closed under finite limits; hence each base change $Y_j := Y \times_X \mathrm{Spec}(A_j)$ is again $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact. For such countable colimits, the descent formula

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_X \simeq \lim_j n\mathrm{Pr}_{A_j}$$

holds not only in $1\mathrm{Pr} = \mathrm{Pr}_{\mathfrak{N}_1}^{\mathrm{L}}$, but also in Pr^{L} , hence on the level of underlying $(\infty, 1)$ -categories. Thus the desired assertions may be checked after pullback to the affine pieces $\mathrm{Spec}(A_j) \rightarrow X$. We may therefore assume that $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$.

By Lemma 4.12 below, we may choose a diagram $(Y_i)_{i \in I}$ over X , together with a compatible cone $Y \rightarrow Y_i$, such that each $f_i: Y_i \rightarrow X$ is bi-countably presented and

$$n\mathrm{Pr}_Y \simeq \mathrm{colim}_{i \in I} n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y_i},$$

where the transition maps are given by pullback. The pullback f_n^* is a morphism in $1\mathrm{Pr}$, hence preserves $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects. For each i , the map f_i is bi-countably presented. Hence, by Theorem 4.7, for $n \geq 2$ the functor

$$f_{i,n,*}: n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_X$$

preserves colimits, is $n\mathrm{Pr}_X$ -linear, and satisfies base change. By Lemma 4.13 below, if $\alpha_i: n\mathrm{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\mathrm{Pr}_Y$ denotes the colimit structure functor and $p_{ij}: Y_j \rightarrow Y_i$ denotes the transition map associated to a morphism $i \rightarrow j$ in I , then

$$f_{n,*}(\alpha_i E) \simeq \mathrm{colim}_{j \in I_{i|}} f_{j,n,*}(p_{ij,n}^* E).$$

Thus $f_{n,*}$ is assembled from the functors $f_{j,n,*}$ by taking $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -filtered colimits. Since filtered colimits of functors preserve colimits, $n\text{Pr}_X$ -linearity, and base change whenever the functors in the system do, it follows that $f_{n,*}$ also commutes with small colimits, tensors by $n\text{Pr}_X$, and base change.

With these properties established, the Künneth formula is proved formally just like in Corollary 4.8. $\square$

Lemma 4.11. *The inclusion*

$$\text{Shv}_{\text{fpqc}}(\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}) \hookrightarrow \text{PSh}(\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})$$

preserves $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -filtered colimits. The same holds for the corresponding fpqc sheaf categories on affines over any fixed affine base.

Moreover, these sheaf categories are $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compactly generated by affines, their $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects are closed under finite limits, and sheafification sends $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact presheaves to $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact sheaves. In particular, for every affine $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, every affine object $\text{Spec}(B) \rightarrow X$ is $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact in $\text{Shv}_{\text{fpqc}}(\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})_{/X}$, and every $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact object in this slice is a countable colimit of affine objects.

Proof. By definition of the fpqc topology on affines, covering sieves are tested on finite covering families. Since finite sets are $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -small, Lemma A.11 shows that fpqc sheaves are closed under $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -filtered colimits in presheaves. The same argument applies on the fpqc site of affines over a fixed affine base.

Now apply Corollary A.12 with $\kappa = \mathfrak{N}_1$, both on $\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}}$ and on the corresponding site over an affine base. This gives $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact generation, closure of $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects under finite limits, and preservation of $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects under sheafification. Since representable presheaves are compact, affine sheaves are $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact.

The sheaf category over an affine X is generated under colimits by affine objects over X . Hence its $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects are retracts of countable colimits of affine objects; absorbing the retract by the usual countable telescope gives the stated countable affine presentation. $\square$

Lemma 4.12. *Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ be affine. Then every $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact object $Y \in \text{Shv}_{\text{fpqc}}(\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})_{/X}$ admits a compatible cone $Y \rightarrow Y_i$ over an $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -filtered category I , where each $Y_i \rightarrow X$ is bi-countably presented, such that, for every $n \geq 1$, the induced functor*

$$\text{colim}_{i \in I} n\text{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_Y$$

along pullback is an equivalence in $1\text{Pr} = \text{Pr}_{\mathfrak{N}_1}^{\text{L}}$.

Proof. By Lemma 4.11, the affine objects over X are $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact. Since affine objects generate $\text{Shv}_{\text{fpqc}}(\text{Aff}_{\mathbb{S}})_{/X}$ under colimits, this sheaf category is $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compactly generated by affines. Thus an $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact object over X admits a presentation by countably many affines: we have

$$Y \simeq \text{colim}_{m \in M} \text{Spec}(B_m)$$

for some countable diagram $B: M^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp})$. Since $\text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp})$ is $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compactly generated, Lemma 1.5 shows that also $\text{Fun}(M^{\text{op}}, \text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp}))$ is $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compactly generated, with $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact objects given by the functors $M^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp})^{\mathfrak{N}_1}$, i.e. the diagrams of countably presented A -algebras. Applying this to the diagram B , we obtain an $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -filtered category I and diagrams $B_i: M^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp})$ such that each $B_i(m)$ is countably presented over A , and we have

$$B \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} B_i$$

in $\text{Fun}(M^{\text{op}}, \text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp}))$. Define

$$Y_i := \text{colim}_{m \in M} \text{Spec}(B_i(m)).$$

Since M is countable and each $A \rightarrow B_i(m)$ is countably presented, each $Y_i \rightarrow X$ is bi-countably presented. The maps $B_i \rightarrow B$ induce a compatible cone $Y \rightarrow Y_i$ over X .

It remains to check the asserted formula after applying $n\text{Pr}_{(-)}$. First consider the affine case: if $B \simeq \text{colim}_i B_i$ in $\text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp})$, then

$$n\text{Pr}_B \simeq \text{colim}_i n\text{Pr}_{B_i}.$$

The base case $n = 0$ follows from Theorem 1.24 applied to $C = \text{Sp}$: the functor $\text{CAlg}_A(\text{Sp}) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(\text{1Pr})_{0\text{Pr}_A/}$, $B \mapsto 0\text{Pr}_B$, is a left adjoint and hence preserves colimits. For higher n the same argument applies inductively, applying the theorem with $C = n\text{Pr}$ and base algebra $(n-1)\text{Pr}_A$.

Now apply descent to the countable affine presentations of Y and the Y_i . Since $B \simeq \text{colim}_i B_i$ in the functor category, we have $B_m \simeq \text{colim}_i B_i(m)$ for every $m \in M$. Hence

$$\begin{aligned} n\text{Pr}_Y &\simeq \lim_{m \in M^{\text{op}}} n\text{Pr}_{B_m} \\ &\simeq \lim_{m \in M^{\text{op}}} \text{colim}_i n\text{Pr}_{B_i(m)}. \end{aligned}$$

Since M is countable and 1Pr is $\aleph_1$ -compactly generated, $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits commute with this countable limit in 1Pr . Thus

$$\begin{aligned} n\text{Pr}_Y &\simeq \text{colim}_i \lim_{m \in M^{\text{op}}} n\text{Pr}_{B_i(m)} \\ &\simeq \text{colim}_i n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}. \end{aligned} \quad \square$$

Lemma 4.13. *Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, and let $(Y_i)_{i \in I}$ be a diagram over X , indexed by an $\aleph_1$ -filtered category I , equipped with a compatible cone $Y \rightarrow Y_i$ over X . Assume that*

$$n\text{Pr}_Y \simeq \text{colim}_{i \in I} n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}$$

in 1Pr along pullback. In particular, the structure functors $\alpha_i: n\text{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_Y$ preserve $\aleph_1$ -compact objects, and compact generators of $n\text{Pr}_Y$ are obtained from compact generators of the stages under countable colimits. Write $f_i: Y_i \rightarrow X$ and $f: Y \rightarrow X$ for the structure maps. For a morphism $i \rightarrow j$ in I , write $p_{ij}: Y_j \rightarrow Y_i$ for the induced transition map. Assume that f_n^ preserves $\aleph_1$ -compact objects and that each right adjoint*

$$f_{i,n,*}: n\text{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_X$$

preserves small colimits. Then $f_{n,}$ preserves small colimits, and, if $\alpha_i: n\text{Pr}_{Y_i} \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_Y$ denotes the colimit structure functor, then*

$$f_{n,*}(\alpha_i E) \simeq \text{colim}_{j \in I_{i/}} f_{j,n,*}(p_{ij,n}^* E)$$

for every $E \in n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}$.

Proof. For fixed i , define

$$G_i(E) := \text{colim}_{j \in I_{i/}} f_{j,n,*}(p_{ij,n}^* E), \quad E \in n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}.$$

Since each $f_{j,n,*}$ preserves colimits, so does G_i . If $i \rightarrow k$ is a morphism in I , then the inclusion $I_{k/} \rightarrow I_{i/}$ is cofinal, and hence

$$G_k(p_{ik,n}^* E) \simeq G_i(E).$$

Thus the restrictions of the G_i to compact objects are compatible with the 1Pr-colimit presentation of $n\text{Pr}_Y$. Since compact generators of $n\text{Pr}_Y$ are generated under countable colimits by the objects $\alpha_i E$ with $E \in (n\text{Pr}_{Y_i})^{\aleph_1}$, these compatible restrictions determine a functor on $(n\text{Pr}_Y)^{\aleph_1}$ preserving countable colimits. Extending it cocontinuously gives a colimit-preserving functor

$$G: n\text{Pr}_Y \rightarrow n\text{Pr}_X$$

with $G(\alpha_i E) \simeq G_i(E)$ for compact E . Since both sides of this formula preserve colimits in E , the same formula holds for all $E \in n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}$.

We claim that G is right adjoint to f_n^* . It suffices to test this on $\aleph_1$ -compact generators $K \in (n\text{Pr}_X)^{\aleph_1}$ and on $\aleph_1$ -compact generators of $n\text{Pr}_Y$ represented by some stage $n\text{Pr}_{Y_i}$. Here we use the 1Pr-colimit presentation and the assumption that f_n^* preserves compact objects. Using compactness of K and the standard mapping-space formula for filtered colimits of categories, we compute

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_{n\text{Pr}_X}(K, G(\alpha_i E)) &\simeq \text{colim}_{j \in I_{i/}} \text{Hom}_{n\text{Pr}_X}(K, f_{j,n,*}(p_{ij,n}^* E)) \\ &\simeq \text{colim}_{j \in I_{i/}} \text{Hom}_{n\text{Pr}_{Y_j}}(f_{j,n}^* K, p_{ij,n}^* E) \\ &\simeq \text{colim}_{j \in I_{i/}} \text{Hom}_{n\text{Pr}_{Y_j}}(p_{ij,n}^* f_{i,n}^* K, p_{ij,n}^* E) \\ &\simeq \text{Hom}_{n\text{Pr}_Y}(f_n^* K, \alpha_i E). \end{aligned}$$

Since $n\text{Pr}_X$ is $\aleph_1$ -compactly generated, this identifies G with the right adjoint $f_{n,*}$. □

4.5 The Stefanich ring functor

We can summarize what we have shown in the language of Stefanich rings:

Corollary 4.14. *The functor*

$$\text{Shv}_{\text{fpqc}}(C)^{\aleph_1} \rightarrow \text{StRing}_{\mathbb{S}/}^{\text{op}}, \quad X \mapsto (\mathcal{O}(X), D(X), 1\text{Pr}_X, 2\text{Pr}_X, \dots)$$

commutes with countable colimits and finite limits.

In other words, if the target were itself an ∞ -topos, then this functor would have all the properties of a morphism of ∞ -topoi (except that we restrict to countable colimits rather than to all small colimits).

Sketch of proof. Commutation with countable colimits holds essentially by definition. To prove commutation with finite limits, it suffices to handle the terminal object (which works by definition of $\text{StRing}_{\mathbb{S}/}$) and pullbacks. So consider a pullback diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Y \times_X Y' & \longrightarrow & Y' \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow f' \\ Y & \xrightarrow{f} & X \end{array}$$

of $\mathfrak{N}_1$ -compact fpqc stacks. A priori, to compute the pushout of Stefanich rings, we would start by forming the infinite tuple

$$(O(Y) \otimes_{O(X)} O(Y'), D(Y) \otimes_{D(X)} D(Y'), 1\mathrm{Pr}_Y \otimes_{1\mathrm{Pr}_X} 1\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}, \dots),$$

consisting of all the levelwise pushouts. These come with natural maps from each entry to endomorphisms of the unit of the next, but these are typically *not* isomorphisms; one needs to “spectrify”, i.e. apply the left adjoint to the inclusion of Stefanich rings into the larger category that allows for non-invertible comparison maps.

In the next talk, we will explain a convenient way of computing such tensor products. What we will see there is that we can make a ‘first approximation’ to the spectrification, given by:

$$(O(Y) \otimes_{D(X)} O(Y'), D(Y) \otimes_{1\mathrm{Pr}_X} D(Y'), 1\mathrm{Pr}_Y \otimes_{2\mathrm{Pr}_X} 1\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}, \dots).$$

Here on each level the tensor product is taken at the next-higher categorical level. (For example, in the zeroth slot we form the tensor product not over $O(X)$, i.e. in $O(X)$ -modules, but rather inside $D(X)$; this is finer, since there is a canonical functor $\mathrm{Mod}_{O(X)}(D(\mathbb{S})) \rightarrow D(X)$.) By Proposition 4.9, starting from the slot $1\mathrm{Pr}_Y \otimes_{2\mathrm{Pr}_X} 1\mathrm{Pr}_{Y'}$, this expression agrees with

$$(O(Y \times_X Y'), D(Y \times_X Y'), 1\mathrm{Pr}_{Y \times_X Y'}, \dots),$$

which is already a Stefanich ring, namely the one corresponding to $Y \times_X Y'$. As the first few terms do not affect the Stefanich ring structure, this gives the desired result. $\square$

Remark 4.15. A general slogan in this area is that “everything becomes affine under sufficient categorification”. The Künneth formulas above, which hold from level $1\mathrm{Pr}$ onwards, justify this slogan in some form. The slogan is a bit imprecise, however: stacks like $B^n \mathbb{G}_m$ are n -affine (in a sense to be made precise in the next talk) but not k -affine for $k < n$, so in particular $\bigsqcup_k B^k \mathbb{G}_m$ is not n -affine for any n . We will later see that even the infinite-dimensional affine space $\mathbb{A}^\infty = \mathrm{colim}_n \mathbb{A}^n$ is not n -affine for any n , although all its terms are 0-affine and the transition maps are cohomologically smooth (since complete intersections are cohomologically smooth in the quasicoherent six-functor formalism).

5 Stefanich rings

Talk given by Yiming.

Recall that we defined the $\aleph_1$ -presentable category StRing of *Stefanich rings* as

$$\begin{aligned} \text{StRing} &:= \text{colim}_{1\text{Pr}}(\text{CAlg}(\text{An}) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}(2\text{Pr}) \hookrightarrow \dots) \\ &\simeq \lim_{\text{CAT}}(\text{CAlg}(\text{An}) \xleftarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr}) \xleftarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \text{CAlg}(2\text{Pr}) \xleftarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \dots). \end{aligned}$$

We denote the objects of this category as $A = (A_0, A_1, A_2, \dots)$, where $A_n \in \text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr})$ and the structure isomorphisms $A_n \simeq \text{End}_{A_{n+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{A_{n+1}})$ are left implicit in the notation. Similarly, morphisms from A to B are collections of maps $f_{n-1}^*: A_n \rightarrow B_n$ compatible with the structural isomorphisms.

Remark 5.1. Given an fpqc stack X , the associated Stefanich ring has $A_n = (n-1)\text{Pr}_X$. The indexing convention for $f_{n-1}^*: A_n \rightarrow B_n$ reflects the convention from the previous lecture.

We may equip StRing with the cocartesian monoidal structure; we will have a look at the resulting “tensor product” of Stefanich rings in more detail below. Since the functor $\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1}): \text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr}) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}((n-1)\text{Pr})$ preserves the monoidal unit, we see that the monoidal unit in StRing is the Stefanich ring $\infty\text{Pr} := (*, \text{An}, 1\text{Pr}, 2\text{Pr}, \dots)$.

Since ∞Pr is initial, every Stefanich ring A receives a unique map $\infty\text{Pr} \rightarrow A$. The individual maps $(n-1)\text{Pr} \rightarrow A_n$ in $\text{CAlg}(\text{Pr})$ are obtained using the identification $\text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr}) \simeq \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr})_{(n-1)\text{Pr}/}$. By passing to right adjoints, we obtain ‘forgetful functors’

$$\text{fgt}: A_n \rightarrow (n-1)\text{Pr}, \quad B_{n-1} \mapsto \underline{\text{Hom}}_{A_n}(\mathbb{1}_{A_n}, B_{n-1}).$$

Given $B_{n-1} \in A_n$, we refer to $\text{fgt}(B_{n-1})$ as its *underlying* $(n-1)$ -category. Note that the underlying $(n-1)$ -category of $\mathbb{1}_{A_n} \in A_n$ is $\text{End}_{A_n}(\mathbb{1}_{A_n}) = A_{n-1}$. We may sometimes abusively denote the unit object of A_n by A_{n-1} .

5.1 Slices over Stefanich rings

We will now provide a limit description of the slice category $\text{StRing}_{A/}$ under any Stefanich ring A .

Construction 5.2. Let $f: A \rightarrow B$ be a morphism of Stefanich rings. For any $n \geq 1$, the symmetric monoidal functor $f_{n-1}^*: A_n \rightarrow B_n$ admits a lax symmetric monoidal right adjoint $f_{n-1,*}: B_n \rightarrow A_n$, which therefore induces a functor of the form

$$f_{n-1,*}: \text{CAlg}(B_n) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_n).$$

Observe that the composite $\text{CAlg}(B_n) \xrightarrow{f_{n-1,*}} \text{CAlg}(A_n) \xrightarrow{\text{fgt}} \text{CAlg}((n-1)\text{Pr})$ is the forgetful functor $\text{CAlg}(B_n) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}((n-1)\text{Pr})$.

We then define

$$(B/A)_{n-1} := f_{n-1,*}(\mathbb{1}_{B_n}) \in \text{CAlg}(A_n).$$

Note that the underlying $(n-1)$ -presentable category of $(B/A)_{n-1}$ is B_{n-1} . So we may think of $(B/A)_{n-1}$ as a lift of B_{n-1} to a commutative algebra in A_n .

Notation 5.3. Recall from Notation 1.25 that, for $C \in \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})$, we have an adjunction

$$\text{CAlg}(C) \underset{E_C}{\overset{M_C}{\rightleftarrows}} \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_C(1\text{Pr})),$$

where $M_C(R) = \text{Mod}_R(C)$ and $E_C(D) = \text{End}_D(\mathbb{1}_D)$. Now let A be a Stefanich ring. Applying this adjunction for $C = 1\text{Pr}$, the structural equivalence

$$A_m \simeq \text{End}_{A_{m+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{A_{m+1}})$$

corresponds to a symmetric monoidal functor

$$L_m : \text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr}) \rightarrow A_{m+1}.$$

We denote its right adjoint by

$$U_m : A_{m+1} \rightarrow \text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr}), \quad X \mapsto \underline{\text{Hom}}_{A_{m+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{A_{m+1}}, X).$$

We use the same notation for the induced functors on commutative algebra objects.

Proposition 5.4. *Given $A \in \text{StRing}$ and $n \geq 1$, there exists a fully faithful functor*

$$\text{CAlg}(A_n) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$$

which is left adjoint to the assignment $B \mapsto (B/A)_{n-1}$. These functors assemble into an equivalence

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \text{colim}_{1\text{Pr}}(\text{CAlg}(A_1) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_2) \hookrightarrow \dots),$$

or equivalently

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \lim_{\text{CAT}}(\text{CAlg}(A_1) \leftarrow \text{CAlg}(A_2) \leftarrow \dots).$$

The equivalence sends B to the tuple $((B/A)_0, (B/A)_1, (B/A)_2, \dots)$.

Proof. Step 1: We start by proving the limit description. By passing to slices, we obtain

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} = \lim_{\text{CAT}}(\dots \xrightarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \text{CAlg}(A_n)_{A_2/} \xrightarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \text{CAlg}(A_n)_{A_1/} \xrightarrow{\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})} \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})_{A_0/}).$$

The entry $\text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})_{A_0/}$ is redundant for the limit, and we will ignore it. Under the equivalences $\text{CAlg}(m\text{Pr})_{A_m/} \simeq (\text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})_{(m-1)\text{Pr}/})_{A_m/} = \text{CAlg}(1\text{Pr})_{A_m/} \simeq \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr}))$, the transition maps $\text{CAlg}((m+1)\text{Pr})_{A_{m+1}/} \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(m\text{Pr})_{A_m/}$ admit the following simple description. An object D of the source is an A_{m+1} -linear monoidal category; the transition sends it to $\text{End}_D(\mathbb{1}_D)$, regarded over $\text{End}_{A_{m+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{A_{m+1}}) \simeq A_m$. Thus the transition factors as

$$\text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_{m+1}}(1\text{Pr})) \xrightarrow{E_{A_{m+1}}} \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1}) \xrightarrow{U_m} \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr})),$$

where we use the notation from Notation 5.3. Hence we may alternatively compute $\text{StRing}_{A/}$ as the limit of the chain

$$\cdots \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_{m+1}}(1\text{Pr})) \xrightarrow{E_{A_{m+1}}} \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1}) \xrightarrow{U_m} \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr})) \xrightarrow{E_{A_m}} \text{CAlg}(A_m) \rightarrow \cdots$$

Removing the intermediate $\text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr}))$ -vertices gives the limit over the composites

$$\Psi_m := E_{A_m} \circ U_m : \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1}) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_m),$$

hence the desired description

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \lim_{\text{CAT}} (\text{CAlg}(A_1) \xleftarrow{\Psi_1} \text{CAlg}(A_2) \xleftarrow{\Psi_2} \cdots).$$

Under this equivalence, an object $f : A \rightarrow B$ is sent in degree $n \geq 1$ to

$$E_{A_n}(B_n) = f_{n-1,*}(\mathbb{1}_{B_n}) = (B/A)_{n-1} \in \text{CAlg}(A_n).$$

Since each functor Ψ_m admits a left adjoint $\Phi_m := L_m \circ M_{A_m}$, we may alternatively compute $\text{StRing}_{A/}$ as a colimit in 1Pr over the left adjoints:

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \text{colim}_{1\text{Pr}} (\text{CAlg}(A_1) \xrightarrow{\Phi_1} \text{CAlg}(A_2) \xrightarrow{\Phi_2} \cdots).$$

Step 2: We next show that each transition functor $\Phi_m : \text{CAlg}(A_m) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$ in the colimit description is fully faithful. Since Φ_m is a morphism in 1Pr , Lemma 1.10 shows that it suffices to check that the unit of the adjunction $\Phi_m \dashv \Psi_m$ is an equivalence on $\aleph_1$ -compact objects, i.e. on countably presented objects of $\text{CAlg}(A_m)$. Let $R \in \text{CAlg}(A_m)$ be countably presented. Since $\Phi_m(R) = L_m(\text{Mod}_R(A_m))$, we get

$$\Psi_m(\Phi_m(R)) \simeq \text{End}_{L_m(\text{Mod}_R(A_m))}(\mathbb{1}).$$

To compute this endomorphism category, consider the free R -module functor

$$F_R : A_m \rightarrow \text{Mod}_R(A_m), \quad X \mapsto R \otimes X.$$

It admits an A_m -linear right adjoint $G_R : \text{Mod}_R(A_m) \rightarrow A_m$, given by forgetting the R -module structure. Since R is countably presented, G_R preserves $\aleph_1$ -compact objects, hence this adjunction lives inside $\text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr})$. Applying the functor of 2-categories $L_m : \text{Mod}_{A_m}(1\text{Pr}) \rightarrow A_{m+1}$, we obtain an adjunction

$$L_m(F_R) : L_m(A_m) \rightleftarrows L_m(\text{Mod}_R(A_m)) : L_m(G_R)$$

in A_{m+1} . In particular, we get

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi_m(\Phi_m(R)) &= \text{End}_{L_m(\text{Mod}_R(A_m))}(\mathbb{1}) \\ &= \text{End}_{L_m(\text{Mod}_R(A_m))}(L_m(F_R)(\mathbb{1}_{A_m})) \\ &= \text{Hom}_{L_m(A_m)}(\mathbb{1}_{A_m}, L_m(G_R)L_m(F_R)(\mathbb{1}_{A_m})) \\ &\simeq L_m(G_R \circ F_R)(\mathbb{1}_{A_m}) \\ &= L_m(R \otimes -)(\mathbb{1}_{A_m}) \\ &= R. \end{aligned}$$

Under this identification, the unit map $R \rightarrow \Psi_m(\Phi_m(R))$ is the map induced by the action of R on the free rank-one R -module $F_R(\mathbb{1}_{A_m})$. Under the adjunction $L_m(F_R) \dashv L_m(G_R)$, this action corresponds to the identity of $G_R F_R(\mathbb{1}_{A_m}) \simeq R$. Thus the unit is an equivalence on countably presented R , and Φ_m is fully faithful.

Step 3: Finally we show that the canonical functors

$$p_n : \text{CAlg}(A_n) \rightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$$

are fully faithful. Under the equivalence

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \lim_{\text{CAT}} (\dots \xrightarrow{\Psi_{n+1}} \text{CAlg}(A_{n+1}) \xrightarrow{\Psi_n} \text{CAlg}(A_n))$$

p_n is left adjoint to the projection $q_n : \text{StRing}_{A/} \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_n)$. We must show that the unit map $R \rightarrow q_n p_n(R)$ is an isomorphism for each $R \in \text{CAlg}(A_n)$. Observe that by fully faithfulness of the functors Φ_m , the sequence of objects

$$X_j = \Phi_{j-1} \Phi_{j-2} \cdots \Phi_n(R) \in \text{CAlg}(A_j)$$

for $j \geq n$ defines an object $X := (X_j)_{j \geq n}$ in this limit. We claim that the identification $R = X_n = q_n(X)$ exhibits X as a left-adjoint object to R under q_n (that is, it induces an isomorphism $X \cong p_n(R)$). Indeed, for any $B \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Hom}_{\text{StRing}_{A/}}(X, B) &\simeq \lim_{j \geq n} \text{Hom}_{\text{CAlg}(A_j)}(X_j, (B/A)_{j-1}) \\ &\simeq \lim_{j \geq n} \text{Hom}_{\text{CAlg}(A_n)}(R, \Psi_n \cdots \Psi_{j-1}((B/A)_{j-1})) \\ &\simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{CAlg}(A_n)}(R, (B/A)_{n-1}). \end{aligned}$$

Here the last equivalence uses the compatibility equivalences $\Psi_i((B/A)_i) \simeq (B/A)_{i-1}$ defining the object B of the limit. This shows that the unit of the adjunction $p_n \dashv q_n$ at $R \in \text{CAlg}(A_n)$ is the identity map $R \rightarrow R$, hence is an isomorphism, showing the fully faithfulness of p_n . $\square$

In the proof of the proposition, we showed that the composite

$$\Phi_m : \text{CAlg}(A_m) \xrightarrow{M_{A_m}} \text{CAlg}(\text{Mod}_{A_m}(\mathbf{1Pr})) \xrightarrow{L_m} \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$$

is fully faithful. While the functor M_{A_m} is also always fully faithful, the functor L_m is usually not. Nevertheless, we still have the following statement:

Lemma 5.5. *Let $A \in \text{StRing}$ and $m \geq 1$. The functor*

$$L_m : \text{Mod}_{A_m}(\mathbf{1Pr}) \rightarrow A_{m+1}$$

is fully faithful on dualizable objects. (In particular, it is fully faithful on $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits of dualizable objects, cf. Lemma 1.10.)

Proof. Set $C := \text{Mod}_{A_m}(\mathbf{1Pr})$ and $D := A_{m+1}$, and let U_m denote the right adjoint of L_m . Let $X, Y \in C$ be dualizable. Since L_m is symmetric monoidal, it preserves duals, and we have a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}_C(X \otimes Y^\vee, \mathbb{1}_C) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Hom}_C(X, Y) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \text{Hom}_D(L_m(X \otimes Y^\vee), \mathbb{1}_D) & \xrightarrow{\sim} & \text{Hom}_D(L_m(X), L_m(Y)). \end{array}$$

The horizontal maps are the usual identifications coming from duality, given by tensoring with Y and precomposing with the coevaluation $\mathbb{1}_C \rightarrow Y^\vee \otimes Y$. Thus it suffices to show that the left vertical map is an equivalence. Composing this map with the adjunction equivalence

$$\mathrm{Hom}_D(L_m(X \otimes Y^\vee), \mathbb{1}_D) \simeq \mathrm{Hom}_C(X \otimes Y^\vee, U_m(\mathbb{1}_D))$$

we see that it suffices to show that the unit map $\mathbb{1}_C \rightarrow U_m L_m \mathbb{1}_C = U_m \mathbb{1}_D$ is an isomorphism. But this map is canonical comparison map $A_m \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{End}_{A_{m+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{A_{m+1}})$, which is an isomorphism as A is a Stefanich ring. $\square$

5.2 Shifting

We will now define the *shift functor* on StRing .

Construction 5.6. The forgetful functors $\mathrm{CAlg}((n+1)\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})$ induce a functor

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{StRing} & \xrightarrow{\simeq} & \lim(\cdots \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(3\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})) \\ \text{shift} \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \mathrm{StRing} & \xrightarrow{=} & \lim(\cdots \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{An})) \end{array}$$

given on objects by $A = (A_1, A_2, \dots) \mapsto (A_2, A_3, \dots)$.

Lemma 5.7. *The shift functor induces an equivalence*

$$\mathrm{shift}: \mathrm{StRing} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{StRing}_{(1\mathrm{Pr}, 2\mathrm{Pr}, \dots)}/.$$

In particular, for any $n \geq 0$, iterated shifting induces an equivalence

$$\mathrm{shift}^n: \mathrm{StRing} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathrm{StRing}_{(n\mathrm{Pr}, (n+1)\mathrm{Pr}, \dots)}/.$$

Proof. Let $S := (1\mathrm{Pr}, 2\mathrm{Pr}, \dots)$. For each $n \geq 1$, we have the identification

$$\mathrm{CAlg}((n+1)\mathrm{Pr}) = \mathrm{CAlg}(\mathrm{Mod}_{n\mathrm{Pr}}(1\mathrm{Pr})) = \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/} = (\mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{(n-1)\mathrm{Pr}/})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/} = \mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/}.$$

These identifications are compatible with the transition functors. Under them, the forgetful functor

$$\mathrm{CAlg}((n+1)\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})$$

is the projection $\mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})_{n\mathrm{Pr}/} \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(n\mathrm{Pr})$, while the same identification remembers the map from $n\mathrm{Pr}$. Since each omitted lower-degree term in the limit presentation of StRing is forced by the next one, we may start the limit at $\mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr})$ and obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{StRing} &\simeq \lim_{\mathrm{CAT}}(\cdots \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(4\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(3\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr})) \\ &\simeq \lim_{\mathrm{CAT}}(\cdots \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(3\mathrm{Pr})_{3\mathrm{Pr}/} \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr})_{2\mathrm{Pr}/} \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})_{1\mathrm{Pr}/}) \\ &\simeq (\lim_{\mathrm{CAT}}(\cdots \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(3\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(2\mathrm{Pr}) \rightarrow \mathrm{CAlg}(1\mathrm{Pr})))_{S/} \\ &\simeq \mathrm{StRing}_{S/}. \end{aligned}$$

Here we use that slices commute with limits in CAT . The resulting functor is precisely shift by construction. The iterated statement follows by applying the same argument repeatedly. $\square$

5.3 Spectrification and colimits of Stefanich rings

Limits and $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits in StRing are computed pointwise, since they are preserved by the transition functors $\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})$ in the limit defining StRing . Arbitrary colimits are harder to describe directly, since they are not (necessarily) preserved by the endomorphism functor.

Definition 5.8. Let

$$\mathcal{P} := \prod_{n \geq 0} \text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr}),$$

and define an endofunctor

$$\Theta: \mathcal{P} \rightarrow \mathcal{P}, \quad (D_n)_{n \geq 0} \mapsto (\text{End}_{D_{n+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{D_{n+1}}))_{n \geq 0}.$$

The category of *preStefanich rings* is the lax equalizer

$$\text{PreStRing} := \mathcal{P} \times_{\mathcal{P} \times \mathcal{P}} \text{Ar}(\mathcal{P}),$$

where $\mathcal{P} \rightarrow \mathcal{P} \times \mathcal{P}$ is (id, Θ) and $\text{Ar}(\mathcal{P}) \rightarrow \mathcal{P} \times \mathcal{P}$ is the source-target functor. Thus a preStefanich ring is a tuple $D = (D_0, D_1, D_2, \dots)$ together with structure maps

$$\alpha_n: D_n \rightarrow \text{End}_{D_{n+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{D_{n+1}})$$

that are not assumed to be equivalences. The category StRing identifies with the full subcategory of PreStRing spanned by those objects for which all α_n are equivalences.

Lemma 5.9. *The category PreStRing admits small colimits, and the projection $\text{PreStRing} \rightarrow \mathcal{P}$ creates them. In particular, colimits in PreStRing are computed pointwise.*

Proof. Let $I \rightarrow \text{PreStRing}$ be a diagram, written as (D^i, α^i) for $i \in I$. Let $D := \text{colim}_i D^i$ in $\mathcal{P}$, so that $D_n \simeq \text{colim}_i D_n^i$ in $\text{CAlg}(n\text{Pr})$. The maps $\alpha^i: D^i \rightarrow \Theta(D^i)$ assemble to a morphism of diagrams $D^\bullet \rightarrow \Theta(D^\bullet)$. Hence we obtain a structure map

$$D \simeq \text{colim}_i D^i \rightarrow \text{colim}_i \Theta(D^i) \rightarrow \Theta(\text{colim}_i D^i) = \Theta(D),$$

where the second arrow is the canonical comparison map induced by the cocone $D^i \rightarrow D$. This defines an object (D, α) of PreStRing .

For any $(Y, \beta) \in \text{PreStRing}$, the hom anima $\text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}((D, \alpha), (Y, \beta))$ is the homotopy equalizer of the two maps

$$\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{P}}(D, Y) \rightrightarrows \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{P}}(D, \Theta Y)$$

defined by $\beta \circ (-)$ and $\Theta(-) \circ \alpha$. Since D is the colimit of the D^i in $\mathcal{P}$, this homotopy equalizer identifies with

$$\lim_i \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}((D^i, \alpha^i), (Y, \beta)).$$

Thus (D, α) has the universal property of the colimit. □

What we will do is to embed StRing in PreStRing and then reflect back.

Lemma 5.10. *The inclusion $\text{StRing} \hookrightarrow \text{PreStRing}$ admits a left adjoint.*

Proof. Define a functor

$$T : \text{PreStRing} \rightarrow \text{PreStRing}, \quad (D_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}} \mapsto (D'_n)_{n \in \mathbb{N}},$$

by setting $D'_n = \text{End}_{D_{n+1}}(\mathbb{1}_{D_{n+1}})$, with structure maps obtained by applying $\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})$ to the structure maps of D . This admits a natural transformation $\eta : \text{id} \rightarrow T$, given by the structure maps of a preStefanich ring. For $X \in \text{PreStRing}$, define $X^{(0)} := X$, $X^{(\alpha+1)} := T(X^{(\alpha)})$, and

$$X^{(\lambda)} := \text{colim}_{\alpha < \lambda} X^{(\alpha)}$$

for limit ordinals λ .

We first show that $X^{(\omega_1)}$ lies in StRing . Since $\text{End}_{(-)}(\mathbb{1})$ preserves $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits, the functor T preserves $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits. Hence

$$T(X^{(\omega_1)}) \simeq T(\text{colim}_{\alpha < \omega_1} X^{(\alpha)}) \simeq \text{colim}_{\alpha < \omega_1} T(X^{(\alpha)}) = \text{colim}_{\alpha < \omega_1} X^{(\alpha+1)} \simeq X^{(\omega_1)}.$$

The last equivalence uses that the successor ordinals are cofinal in ω_1 . Under these identifications, the structure map $X^{(\omega_1)} \rightarrow T(X^{(\omega_1)})$ is the canonical map

$$\text{colim}_{\alpha < \omega_1} X^{(\alpha)} \rightarrow \text{colim}_{\alpha < \omega_1} X^{(\alpha+1)},$$

hence is an equivalence. Thus $X^{(\omega_1)}$ is a Stefanich ring.

It remains to prove the universal property. Let $Y \in \text{StRing}$. We claim by transfinite induction that the natural map

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X^{(\alpha)}, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X, Y)$$

is an equivalence for every ordinal $\alpha \leq \omega_1$. The claim is clear for $\alpha = 0$. For a successor ordinal, it suffices to show that

$$\eta_{X^{(\alpha)}}^* : \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(TX^{(\alpha)}, Y) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X^{(\alpha)}, Y)$$

is an equivalence. Since Y is a Stefanich ring, the map $\eta_Y : Y \rightarrow TY$ is an equivalence. An inverse to $\eta_{X^{(\alpha)}}^*$ is therefore given by applying T to a map $X^{(\alpha)} \rightarrow Y$ and then using η_Y^{-1} to identify TY with Y .

For a limit ordinal λ , the object $X^{(\lambda)}$ is the colimit of the $X^{(\alpha)}$ for $\alpha < \lambda$, so

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X^{(\lambda)}, Y) \simeq \lim_{\alpha < \lambda} \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X^{(\alpha)}, Y) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X, Y).$$

Taking $\alpha = \omega_1$ gives

$$\text{Hom}_{\text{StRing}}(X^{(\omega_1)}, Y) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\text{PreStRing}}(X, Y),$$

naturally in X and Y . Thus $X \mapsto X^{(\omega_1)}$ is left adjoint to the inclusion. $\square$

Corollary 5.11. *We may compute colimits in StRing by computing them in PreStRing (where they are computed pointwise) and then reflect them back into StRing .* $\square$

5.4 Tensor products of Stefanich rings

Consider a diagram of the form $B \leftarrow A \rightarrow C$. We wish to compute the pushout $B \otimes_A C$ in StRing . As we showed in Corollary 5.11, we can do this by computing the pushout in PreStRing , where colimits are pointwise by Lemma 5.9. This gives the preStefanich ring

$$(B_0 \otimes_{A_0} C_0, B_1 \otimes_{A_1} C_1, \dots),$$

and the actual tensor product is obtained by spectrifying this object.

In certain situations, it is useful to do a relative version of the same construction which uses the slice description from Proposition 5.4.

Construction 5.12. Fix a Stefanich ring $A \in \text{StRing}$, and write

$$\text{StRing}_{A/} \simeq \lim_{\text{CAT}} (\text{CAlg}(A_1) \xleftarrow{\Psi_1^A} \text{CAlg}(A_2) \xleftarrow{\Psi_2^A} \dots).$$

Let

$$\mathcal{P}_A := \prod_{m \geq 0} \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$$

and define

$$\Theta_A: \mathcal{P}_A \rightarrow \mathcal{P}_A, \quad (R_m)_{m \geq 0} \mapsto (\Psi_{m+1}^A(R_{m+1}))_{m \geq 0}.$$

We define the category of *preStefanich rings under A* by the analogous lax equalizer

$$\text{PreStRing}_{A/} := \mathcal{P}_A \times_{\mathcal{P}_A \times \mathcal{P}_A} \text{Ar}(\mathcal{P}_A).$$

Thus an object is a sequence $R_m \in \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$ equipped with maps

$$R_m \rightarrow \Psi_{m+1}^A(R_{m+1}).$$

The category $\text{StRing}_{A/}$ is the full subcategory where all these maps are equivalences. Just as before, colimits in $\text{PreStRing}_{A/}$ are computed pointwise, and the inclusion $\text{StRing}_{A/} \hookrightarrow \text{PreStRing}_{A/}$ admits a left adjoint obtained by iterating Θ_A ; here we use that the functors Ψ_m^A preserve $\aleph_1$ -filtered colimits, as they are right adjoints of the morphisms Φ_m^A in 1Pr.

Now let $B, C \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$. Under the equivalence of Proposition 5.4, they correspond to the sequences $((B/A)_m)_{m \geq 0}$ and $((C/A)_m)_{m \geq 0}$. Their coproduct in the relative preStefanich category is therefore the pointwise tensor product

$$((B/A)_0 \otimes (C/A)_0, (B/A)_1 \otimes (C/A)_1, \dots),$$

where the m -th tensor product is formed in $\text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$. The coproduct in $\text{StRing}_{A/}$ is obtained by spectrifying this relative preStefanich ring.

Note that this method of computing the tensor product was already used at the end of the previous talk, in the proof of Corollary 4.14.

Construction 5.13. In a yet more refined way, let $g : A \rightarrow C$ be a morphism of Stefanich rings. The cobase-change functor

$$g^* : \text{StRing}_{A/} \rightarrow \text{StRing}_{C/}, \quad B \mapsto B \otimes_A C$$

is computed by passing from the relative preStefanich category under A to the relative preStefanich category under C . Namely, first apply levelwise extension of scalars

$$g_m^* : \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1}) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(C_{m+1})$$

to the sequence attached to B . This produces the preStefanich ring under C

$$(g_0^*(B/A)_0, g_1^*(B/A)_1, g_2^*(B/A)_2, \dots).$$

The structure maps are obtained by applying g_m^* to the structure maps of B and then using the natural comparison

$$g_m^*(\Psi_{m+1}^A(R)) \rightarrow \Psi_{m+1}^C(g_{m+1}^*(R)), \quad R \in \text{CAlg}(A_{m+2}).$$

In other words, for $R_m = (B/A)_m$, the structure map is the composite

$$g_m^* R_m \rightarrow g_m^* \Psi_{m+1}^A(R_{m+1}) \rightarrow \Psi_{m+1}^C(g_{m+1}^* R_{m+1}).$$

Spectrifying this pre-object in $\text{PreStRing}_{C/}$ gives $B \otimes_A C$. Thus the displayed tuple should be viewed as the first approximation to the base change; the spectrification step is what forces the transition maps to become equivalences.

5.5 Affineness

Definition 5.14. Consider $n \geq 0$, and let $A \in \text{StRing}$ be a Stefanich ring. Then $B \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$ is called *n-affine* if it lies in the essential image of the functor $\text{CAlg}(A_{n+1}) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$.

Let us spell this out in terms of the limit description from Proposition 5.4. For $m \geq 0$, the left adjoint transition functor is

$$\Phi_{m+1}^A = L_{m+1} \circ M_{A_{m+1}} : \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1}) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_{m+2}),$$

and it sends $(B/A)_m$ to

$$\Phi_{m+1}^A((B/A)_m) = L_{m+1}(\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1})).$$

Thus B is n -affine if and only if, compatibly with the transition equivalences in the limit description, the relative algebras of B are obtained for all $m \geq n$ by equivalences

$$(B/A)_{m+1} \simeq L_{m+1}(\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1})).$$

In other words, B is determined from the single algebra $(B/A)_n \in \text{CAlg}(A_{n+1})$ by repeatedly passing to module categories, internally to the Stefanich ring A ; the terms below degree n are then forced by the right adjoint transition functors in the limit description.

The role of Lemma 5.5 is that this recursive construction does not lose information on the objects that occur here. Indeed, if $R \in \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$ is countably presented, then $\text{Mod}_R(A_{m+1})$ is dualizable

in $\text{Mod}_{A_{m+1}}(1\text{Pr})$. More generally, after writing R as an $\mathfrak{S}_1$ -filtered colimit of countably presented algebras, $\text{Mod}_R(A_{m+1})$ is an $\mathfrak{S}_1$ -filtered colimit of dualizable objects. On this class, the functor

$$L_{m+1} : \text{Mod}_{A_{m+1}}(1\text{Pr}) \rightarrow A_{m+2}$$

is fully faithful.

Remark 5.15. We have a factorization $\text{CAlg}(A_{n+1}) \hookrightarrow \text{CAlg}(A_{n+2}) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$. In particular, any n -affine Stefanich ring under A is also $(n+1)$ -affine.

Here are some basic properties of affineness:

Proposition 5.16. *Let $n \geq 0$ and $A \in \text{StRing}$.*

- (1) *The class of n -affines over A is closed under small colimits.*
- (2) *If $B \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$ is n -affine, then the comparison map $\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1}) \rightarrow B_{m+1}$ is an equivalence for $m \geq n$.*
- (3) *Given a map $g : A \rightarrow C$ in StRing and if $B \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$ is n -affine, then also $g^*B = B \otimes_A C \in \text{StRing}_{C/}$ is n -affine. Moreover, we have*

$$g_m^*(B/A)_m \simeq (B \otimes_A C/C)_m$$

for $m \geq n$.

- (4) *Given maps $f : A \rightarrow B$ and $h : B \rightarrow C$ in StRing with composite $g : A \rightarrow C$, if f is n -affine, then g is n -affine if and only if h is.*

Proof. (1) is clear, since $\text{CAlg}(A_{n+1}) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$ is a fully faithful left adjoint.

(2) Let $m \geq n$, and let U_{m+1} denote the right adjoint of

$$L_{m+1} : \text{Mod}_{A_{m+1}}(1\text{Pr}) \rightarrow A_{m+2}.$$

The comparison map in question is the unit map

$$\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1}) \rightarrow U_{m+1}L_{m+1}(\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1})),$$

followed by the identification of the target with B_{m+1} . Indeed, by the recursive description above, since B is n -affine over A , we have

$$L_{m+1}(\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1})) \simeq (B/A)_{m+1}.$$

Moreover, by the discussion preceding the proposition, after writing $(B/A)_m$ as an $\mathfrak{S}_1$ -filtered colimit of countably presented algebras, the object $\text{Mod}_{(B/A)_m}(A_{m+1})$ is an $\mathfrak{S}_1$ -filtered colimit of dualizable objects. Hence Lemma 5.5 implies that the above unit map is an equivalence. Applying the displayed identification, the target becomes

$$U_{m+1}((B/A)_{m+1}) = \text{fgt}((B/A)_{m+1}) \simeq B_{m+1},$$

as desired.

(3) We use the description of cobase change from Construction 5.13. The pre-object whose spectrification computes g^*B is represented in $\text{PreStRing}_{C/}$ by the sequence

$$(g_0^*(B/A)_0, g_1^*(B/A)_1, g_2^*(B/A)_2, \dots).$$

For $m \geq n$, the recursive description of n -affineness gives

$$(B/A)_{m+1} \simeq \Phi_{m+1}^A((B/A)_m).$$

Extension of scalars is compatible with these transition functors, in the sense that for $R \in \text{CAlg}(A_{m+1})$ we have

$$g_{m+1}^* \Phi_{m+1}^A(R) \simeq \Phi_{m+1}^C(g_m^* R).$$

Thus the transition maps of the above preStefanich ring are already equivalences in all degrees $m \geq n$. Spectrification therefore leaves those degrees unchanged, and the result is the n -affine Stefanich ring over C determined by $g_n^*(B/A)_n$. In particular,

$$g_m^*(B/A)_m \simeq (B \otimes_A C/C)_m$$

for $m \geq n$.

(4) Assume B is n -affine over A , so that it is the image of $(B/A)_n \in \text{CAlg}(A_{n+1})$. Slicing the fully faithful functor

$$\text{CAlg}(A_{n+1}) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{A/}$$

at this object gives a fully faithful functor

$$\text{CAlg}(A_{n+1})_{(B/A)_n/} \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{B/},$$

whose essential image consists precisely of those objects $C \in \text{StRing}_{B/}$ for which the composite $A \rightarrow C$ is n -affine. On the other hand, by part (2),

$$B_{n+1} \simeq \text{Mod}_{(B/A)_n}(A_{n+1}),$$

and therefore

$$\text{CAlg}(B_{n+1}) \simeq \text{CAlg}(A_{n+1})_{(B/A)_n/}.$$

Under this equivalence, the functor $\text{CAlg}(B_{n+1}) \hookrightarrow \text{StRing}_{B/}$ has the same essential image as the sliced functor above. Thus C is n -affine over B if and only if it is n -affine over A . $\square$

Remark 5.17. The converse to part (2) is *not* necessarily true. Let k be a field, let

$$f: * \rightarrow \mathbb{B}^2\mathbb{G}_m$$

be the base point, and let $A \rightarrow B$ be the corresponding map of Stefanich rings. One can show that f is 1-affine, so the comparison in part (2) is an equivalence for $m \geq 1$. It is also an equivalence for $m = 0$: here $A_1 = B_1 = D(k)$ and $(B/A)_0 = k$, so the comparison is just

$$\text{Mod}_k(D(k)) \simeq D(k).$$

Nevertheless f is not 0-affine. Indeed, if it were 0-affine, then B would be determined over A by the algebra $(B/A)_0 \in \text{CAlg}(A_1)$. But $(B/A)_0 = k$ is the unit algebra, and the 0-affine object corresponding to the unit is just the identity object $A \in \text{StRing}_{A/}$. This would force $A \simeq B$, i.e. $* \simeq \mathbb{B}^2\mathbb{G}_m$, which is false.

6 Proper and étale maps of Stefanich rings

Talk given by Tashi.

7 Gestalten

Talk given by Giovanni.

8 Examples

Talk given by Divya.

9 Descendability

Talk given by Shai.

10 Six functors and Gestalten

Talk given by Ou.

11 The Gestalt $[\mathrm{Spec}(\mathbb{Z})]_{\mathrm{SH}}$

Talk given by Marco.

12 Cartier duality

Talk given by Han-Ung.

13 The proof of Cartier duality

Talk given by Sil.

A $\aleph_1$ -compact objects

The formalism developed in these notes heavily relies on manipulations with κ -compact objects for uncountable cardinals κ (which we mostly fix to be $\aleph_1$). In this appendix, we record various basic properties of κ -compact objects.

A.1 Compact algebras and modules

We state and prove various basic properties of κ -compact algebras in a κ -presentable category.

Lemma A.1. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let $C \in \mathbf{CAlg}(\mathbf{Pr}_\kappa^{\mathbf{L}})$, let $R \in \mathbf{CAlg}(C)$, and let $B \in \mathbf{CAlg}_R(C)$. Then B is κ -compact as an R -algebra if and only if its underlying R -module is κ -compact.*

Proof. The point is that the E_∞ -operad is countable. We write

$$\mathrm{Sym}_R : \mathrm{Mod}_R(C) \rightleftarrows \mathbf{CAlg}_R(C) : U$$

for the free-forgetful adjunction. We will use that κ -small colimits of κ -compact objects are again κ -compact: mapping out of such a colimit gives a κ -small limit of anima, and κ -filtered colimits of anima commute with κ -small limits.

First let $M \in \mathrm{Mod}_R(C)$ be κ -compact. The underlying R -module of the free commutative R -algebra on M is

$$U \mathrm{Sym}_R(M) \simeq \coprod_{d \geq 0} (M^{\otimes_R d})_{h\Sigma_d}.$$

Here each tensor power is κ -compact, the homotopy orbits are a countable colimit, and the coproduct is countable. Thus $U \mathrm{Sym}_R(M)$ is κ -compact. Also $\mathrm{Sym}_R(M)$ is κ -compact as an algebra, since U preserves κ -filtered colimits.

Since the monad $U \mathrm{Sym}_R$ is κ -accessible and preserves κ -compact objects by the formula above, the κ -compact objects in $\mathbf{CAlg}_R(C)$ are generated under κ -small colimits and retracts by free algebras on κ -compact modules. Indeed, for any κ -accessible monad on a κ -presentable category which preserves κ -compact objects, the free algebras on κ -compact objects are κ -compact and generate the algebra category under colimits, so the κ -compact algebras are the retracts of their κ -small colimits.

It remains to check that the class of R -algebras with κ -compact underlying R -module is closed under these operations. Closure under retracts is clear. For κ -small colimits, write such a colimit as the geometric realization of its simplicial replacement; the n -simplices are κ -small coproducts of the algebras in the diagram. A κ -small coproduct of commutative R -algebras is the sifted colimit over its

finite sub-coproducts, and the underlying R -module of a finite coproduct is the corresponding finite tensor product in $\text{Mod}_R(C)$. Since U preserves sifted colimits, and since κ -compact R -modules are closed under finite tensor products and κ -small colimits, the underlying module of each simplicial degree, and hence of the realization, is κ -compact. Thus a κ -compact R -algebra has κ -compact underlying R -module.

Conversely, suppose that $U(B)$ is κ -compact. By monadicity, B is the geometric realization of the standard simplicial resolution by free algebras,

$$\cdots \rightrightarrows \text{Sym}_R U \text{Sym}_R U(B) \rightrightarrows \text{Sym}_R U(B).$$

By the free-algebra case above, every term in this simplicial object is κ -compact as an algebra. Since the geometric realization is a countable colimit, B is κ -compact in $\text{CAlg}_R(C)$. $\square$

Lemma A.2. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$, and let $A \rightarrow B$ be κ -compact in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$. Then an object $M \in \text{Mod}_B(C)$ is κ -compact as a B -module if and only if its underlying A -module is κ -compact.*

Proof. By Lemma A.1, the underlying A -module of B is κ -compact. We write

$$f^* = B \otimes_A -: \text{Mod}_A(C) \rightleftarrows \text{Mod}_B(C): f_*$$

for the extension-restriction adjunction. First suppose that M is κ -compact as a B -module. The κ -compact objects in $\text{Mod}_B(C)$ are generated under κ -small colimits and retracts by the free B -modules $B \otimes X$ with $X \in C^\kappa$. Since f_* preserves colimits and sends such a free module to $B \otimes X$, which is κ -compact as an A -module because the C -action on $\text{Mod}_A(C)$ preserves κ -compact objects, it follows that f_*M is κ -compact.

Conversely, suppose that f_*M is κ -compact as an A -module. The standard monadic resolution

$$M \simeq |\cdots \rightrightarrows f^* f_* f^* f_* M \rightrightarrows f^* f_* M|$$

expresses M as a countable colimit of B -modules of the form f^*N . Since $f_* f^* N \simeq B \otimes_A N$ and the tensor product on $\text{Mod}_A(C)$ preserves κ -compact objects in both variables, the functor $f_* f^*$ preserves κ -compact A -modules. Hence every term in this resolution is of the form f^*N with N κ -compact as an A -module, and is therefore κ -compact as a B -module. Since the realization is a countable, hence κ -small, colimit, M is κ -compact. $\square$

Corollary A.3. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$, and let $g: R \rightarrow S$ be κ -compact in $\text{CAlg}_R(C)$. Then the restriction functor*

$$g_*: \text{Mod}_S(C) \rightarrow \text{Mod}_R(C)$$

preserves κ -compact objects.

Proof. This is one direction of Lemma A.2. $\square$

Lemma A.4. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^{\text{L}})$, and let $A \in \text{CAlg}(C)$.*

(1) The κ -compact objects in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$ are closed under κ -small colimits and retracts. In particular, they are closed under finite colimits.

- (2) If $B \in \text{CAlg}_A(C)$ is κ -compact and $A \rightarrow A'$ is any map in $\text{CAlg}(C)$, then $A' \otimes_A B \in \text{CAlg}_{A'}(C)$ is κ -compact.
- (3) If $B \in \text{CAlg}_A(C)$ is κ -compact and $D \in \text{CAlg}_B(C)$ is κ -compact, then D is κ -compact as an object of $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$.
- (4) If $B, D \in \text{CAlg}_A(C)$ are κ -compact and $B \rightarrow D$ is a map in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$, then D is κ -compact as an object of $\text{CAlg}_B(C)$.

Proof. Part (1) is the general closure property of κ -compact objects in a κ -presentable category. For (2), extension of scalars

$$A' \otimes_A - : \text{CAlg}_A(C) \rightarrow \text{CAlg}_{A'}(C)$$

is left adjoint to the forgetful functor, and this forgetful functor preserves κ -filtered colimits.

For (3), Lemma A.1 shows that D is κ -compact as a B -module. By Lemma A.2, its underlying A -module is κ -compact, so Lemma A.1 again shows that D is κ -compact as an A -algebra.

For (4), the underlying A -module of D is κ -compact by Lemma A.1. Since B is κ -compact over A , Lemma A.2 implies that D is κ -compact as a B -module. Applying Lemma A.1 once more, D is κ -compact as a B -algebra. $\square$

Lemma A.5. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let $C \in \text{CAlg}(\text{Pr}_\kappa^L)$, and let $A \rightarrow B$ be κ -compact in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$. If $A \rightarrow B$ admits an A -algebra retraction $B \rightarrow A$, then A is κ -compact as an object of $\text{CAlg}_B(C)$.*

Proof. Apply Lemma A.4(4) to the map $B \rightarrow A$ in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$: both B and the initial A -algebra A are κ -compact in $\text{CAlg}_A(C)$. $\square$

A.2 Compact objects in sheaf categories

We now collect the compactness facts for presheaves and left exact localizations which are used in the main text.

Lemma A.6. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, and let C be a small category with finite limits. Then finite limits of κ -small coproducts of representables in $\text{PSh}(C)$ are again κ -small coproducts of representables.*

Proof. The terminal object is representable, so it is enough to prove stability under pullbacks. Let

$$F = \coprod_{a \in A} y(c_a), \quad G = \coprod_{b \in B} y(d_b), \quad H = \coprod_{e \in E} y(h_e)$$

with A, B, E κ -small. Consider maps $F \rightarrow H$ and $G \rightarrow H$. For each $a \in A$, the restriction $y(c_a) \rightarrow H$ chooses a summand $e(a) \in E$ and a map $c_a \rightarrow h_{e(a)}$ in C . Similarly, for each $b \in B$, the restriction $y(d_b) \rightarrow H$ chooses a summand $e'(b) \in E$ and a map $d_b \rightarrow h_{e'(b)}$.

Coproducts in a presheaf ∞ -topos are disjoint and universal. Therefore the pullback $F \times_H G$ decomposes as

$$F \times_H G \simeq \coprod_{\substack{(a,b) \in A \times B \\ e(a)=e'(b)}} \left(y(c_a) \times_{y(h_{e(a)})} y(d_b) \right).$$

Since the Yoneda embedding preserves finite limits, the summand is represented by $c_a \times_{h_e(a)} d_b$. The displayed coproduct is κ -small, because κ is infinite and A and B are κ -small. This proves stability under pullbacks, and hence under all finite limits. $\square$

Proposition A.7. *Let C be a small category, let I be an ordinary small category, let $F: I \rightarrow \mathbf{PSh}(C)$ be a diagram, and let $i, j \in I$. There is a simplicial object*

$$B_{\bullet}^{i,j}(F) \in \mathbf{Fun}(\Delta^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{PSh}(C)),$$

defined naturally in F , with a natural equivalence

$$|B_{\bullet}^{i,j}(F)| \simeq F(i) \times_{\mathrm{colim}_I F} F(j).$$

Moreover, each $B_q^{i,j}(F)$ is a coproduct, indexed by a set of finite necklace diagrams in I from i to j , of objects of the form

$$\lim_K F,$$

where $K \rightarrow I$ is the finite diagram attached to the necklace datum, and $\lim_K F$ denotes the limit of the composite $K \rightarrow I \xrightarrow{F} \mathbf{PSh}(C)$. In particular, if I is countable, then each $B_q^{i,j}(F)$ is a countable coproduct of finite limits of values of F .

Proof. We may alternatively interpret F as a functor $C^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Fun}(I, \mathbf{An})$. Similarly, we will interpret the simplicial objects $B_{\bullet}^{i,j}$ as functors $C^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{Fun}(\Delta^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathbf{An})$. Since the construction we give is natural in F , and limits and colimits in $\mathbf{PSh}(C)$ are computed objectwise, we may assume that $F: I \rightarrow \mathbf{An}$.

Let

$$p: D := \int_I F \longrightarrow I$$

be the left fibration classifying F , given by the covariant Grothendieck construction. The fiber D_i is the anima $F(i)$, and a morphism of D over $\alpha: i \rightarrow i'$ in I amounts to a point $x \in F(i)$ together with a path $F(\alpha)(x) \simeq x'$ in $F(i')$. The colimit of F is the groupoid completion of its category of elements,

$$\mathrm{colim}_I F \simeq |D|,$$

where $|D|$ denotes the geometric realization of the nerve of D . Under this equivalence the canonical map $F(i) \rightarrow \mathrm{colim}_I F$ is the composite $D_i \hookrightarrow D \rightarrow |D|$. We must compute the pullback $D_i \times_{|D|} D_j$.

We now use the necklace formula for mapping spaces in $|D|$. Let $\mathbf{Nec}$ denote the ordinary category of necklaces: its objects are bipointed simplicial sets of the form

$$N = \Delta^{n_1} \vee \cdots \vee \Delta^{n_r},$$

and its morphisms are maps of bipointed simplicial sets. If $X: \Delta^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{An}$ is a simplicial anima, then a map $N \rightarrow X$ has two endpoint evaluations in X_0 . For maps $A \rightarrow X_0$ and $B \rightarrow X_0$ of animae, we write $\mathbf{Nec}_{/(X,A,B)}$ for the Grothendieck construction of the functor

$$\mathbf{Nec}^{\mathrm{op}} \longrightarrow \mathbf{An}, \quad N \longmapsto A \times_{X_0} \mathbf{Map}_{\mathbf{PSh}(\Delta)}(N, X) \times_{X_0} B.$$

For points $a, b \in X_0$ this specializes to a category $\mathbf{Nec}_{/(X,a,b)}$ by taking $A = \{a\}$ and $B = \{b\}$.

For a category E , let $\mathbf{R}(E): \Delta^{\mathrm{op}} \rightarrow \mathbf{An}$ denote the Rezk classification diagram of the relative category (E, E) , so that

$$\mathbf{R}(E)_n = |\mathbf{Fun}([n], E)|.$$

Its associated complete Segal space presents the localization $E[E^{-1}] = |E|$. If $a, b \in E$, the necklace formula of Barkan and Steinebrunner [BS23, Theorem A and the mapping-space formula of Section 2] applied to $R(E)$ gives

$$|\mathrm{Nec}_{/R(E), a, b}| \simeq \mathrm{Map}_{|E|}(a, b),$$

where the objects $a, b \in E$ are viewed as points of $R(E)_0 = |E|$. Letting the endpoints vary in arbitrary anima A, B equipped with maps to $|E|$, and using universality of colimits in An , gives a natural equivalence

$$|\mathrm{Nec}_{/R(E), A, B}| \simeq A \times_{|E|} B.$$

Apply this with $E = D$, $A = D_i \simeq F(i)$, and $B = D_j \simeq F(j)$. Define $B_{\bullet}^{i, j}(F)$, after the present objectwise reduction, to be the simplicial anima underlying $\mathrm{Nec}_{/R(D), D_i, D_j}$, expanded by writing each space $|\mathrm{Fun}([n], D)|$ as the geometric realization of the nerve of $\mathrm{Fun}([n], D)$. Then

$$|B_{\bullet}^{i, j}(F)| \simeq F(i) \times_{\mathrm{colim}_I F} F(j).$$

Doing the same construction objectwise gives the desired simplicial object in presheaves.

It remains to identify the degrees. Unwinding the Grothendieck construction above, a q -simplex consists of a chain of necklaces

$$N_0 \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow N_q$$

in Nec and a q -simplex of

$$A \times_{R(E)_0} \mathrm{Map}_{\mathrm{PSh}(\Delta)}(N_q, R(E)) \times_{R(E)_0} B.$$

Since N_q is a finite gluing of simplices, the middle mapping anima is a finite limit of terms $R(E)_n = |\mathrm{Fun}([n], E)|$. After replacing each such realization by the nerve of $\mathrm{Fun}([n], E)$, a simplex over I is therefore described by finitely many ordinals, maps between the corresponding necklaces, functors from these finite ordinals to I , and natural transformations between such functors, subject to the finitely many compatibility conditions imposed by the gluing of the necklace and by the endpoints i, j . Equivalently, it determines a finite category K_σ and a functor $u_\sigma: K_\sigma \rightarrow I$. The summand of $B_q^{i, j}(F)$ lying over σ is the anima of lifts of u_σ along the left fibration p , or equivalently the anima of sections of $u_\sigma^* D \rightarrow K_\sigma$. By straightening over K_σ , this anima is

$$\mathrm{Map}_{\mathrm{Fun}(K_\sigma, \mathrm{An})}(*, F \circ u_\sigma) \simeq \lim_{K_\sigma} (F \circ u_\sigma).$$

Therefore

$$B_q^{i, j}(F) \simeq \coprod_{\sigma} \lim_{K_\sigma} (F \circ u_\sigma),$$

where σ runs over the finite necklace diagrams in I of simplicial degree q with endpoints i and j . Each K_σ is finite. If I is countable, then there are only countably many such finite diagrams. Hence each $B_q^{i, j}(F)$ is a countable coproduct of finite limits of values of F . $\square$

Corollary A.8. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let C be a small category with finite limits, and let $Y_\bullet$ be a simplicial object of $\mathrm{PSh}(C)$ such that every Y_n is a κ -small coproduct of representables. Then*

$$Y_0 \times_{|Y_\bullet|} Y_0$$

is a κ -small colimit of representables.

Proof. Apply Proposition A.7 to the ordinary category $I = \Delta^{\text{op}}$, the two objects $i = j = [0]$, and the diagram $Y_\bullet : \Delta^{\text{op}} \rightarrow \text{PSh}(C)$. Since Δ^{op} is countable, the relation object is the geometric realization of a simplicial object whose q -simplices are countable coproducts of finite limits of the Y_n . By Lemma A.6, each such finite limit is a κ -small coproduct of representables. Since κ is uncountable regular, countable coproducts and countable geometric realizations of κ -small coproducts of representables are κ -small colimits of representables. This proves the claim. $\square$

Proposition A.9. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, and let C be a small category with finite limits. Then the κ -compact objects of $\text{PSh}(C)$ are closed under finite limits.*

Proof. The category $\text{PSh}(C)$ is κ -compactly generated by representables, and its κ -compact objects are κ -small colimits of representables. Indeed, the only point is to absorb retracts: if X is a retract of Y in a category with countable colimits, represented by an idempotent $e : Y \rightarrow Y$, then

$$X \simeq \text{colim} \left(Y \xrightarrow{e} Y \xrightarrow{e} Y \xrightarrow{e} \dots \right).$$

The terminal object of $\text{PSh}(C)$ is representable, hence κ -compact. We are thus reduced to pullbacks. Let

$$X \rightarrow Y \leftarrow Z$$

be a diagram in which all three objects are κ -small colimits of representables. We first reduce to the case where X and Z are representable. Write $X \simeq \text{colim}_i X_i$ and $Z \simeq \text{colim}_j Z_j$ as κ -small colimits of representables, with the induced maps to Y . Since colimits in a presheaf topos are universal, pullback in the slice over Y preserves colimits. Hence

$$X \times_Y Z \simeq \text{colim}_{i,j} (X_i \times_Y Z_j).$$

The indexing category is still κ -small, so it remains to handle the case where X and Z are representable.

Write Y as a κ -small colimit of representables. The simplicial replacement expresses this colimit as the geometric realization of a simplicial object $Y_\bullet$ of $\text{PSh}(C)$ such that each Y_n is a κ -small coproduct of representables. The map $Y_0 \rightarrow |Y_\bullet|$ is an effective epimorphism. Since effective epimorphisms in An are the π_0 -surjections, maps from representables lift in the slice along effective epimorphisms after evaluation. Thus the two maps $X, Z \rightarrow |Y_\bullet|$ admit lifts to Y_0 .

Set

$$R := Y_0 \times_{|Y_\bullet|} Y_0.$$

Then

$$X \times_{|Y_\bullet|} Z \simeq (X \times Z) \times_{Y_0 \times Y_0} R,$$

where the map $X \times Z \rightarrow Y_0 \times Y_0$ is induced by the chosen lifts. By Corollary A.8, the object R is a κ -small colimit $\text{colim}_\ell R_\ell$ of representables. Since colimits in a presheaf topos are universal,

$$(X \times Z) \times_{Y_0 \times Y_0} R \simeq \text{colim}_\ell ((X \times Z) \times_{Y_0 \times Y_0} R_\ell).$$

Each term on the right is a finite limit of κ -small coproducts of representables, hence is itself a κ -small coproduct of representables by Lemma A.6. Therefore $X \times_Y Z$ is a κ -small colimit of representables. $\square$

Lemma A.10. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, and let*

$$L: C \rightleftarrows D : \iota$$

be an accessible localization of presentable categories. Assume that C is κ -compactly generated, that C^κ is closed under finite limits, that L preserves finite limits, and that ι preserves κ -filtered colimits. Then D is κ -compactly generated, and D^κ is closed under finite limits.

Proof. Since ι preserves κ -filtered colimits, the left adjoint L preserves κ -compact objects. Thus LK is κ -compact for every $K \in C^\kappa$.

We next show that these objects generate D under κ -filtered colimits. In fact, we will exhibit every object $d \in D$ as an explicit κ -filtered colimit of objects of this form. Observe that the category

$$(C^\kappa)_{/\iota d}$$

is κ -filtered: a κ -small diagram of maps $K_\alpha \rightarrow \iota d$ is dominated by the map $\text{colim}_\alpha K_\alpha \rightarrow \iota d$, and C^κ is closed under κ -small colimits. Since C is κ -compactly generated, the canonical map

$$\text{colim}_{(K \rightarrow \iota d)} K \rightarrow \iota d$$

is an equivalence. Applying L gives

$$\text{colim}_{(K \rightarrow \iota d)} LK \simeq d.$$

Thus D is κ -compactly generated by the objects LK . Moreover, if d is κ -compact, then the identity of d factors through one of the structure maps $LK \rightarrow d$, so d is a retract of some LK .

Now let $F: J \rightarrow D^\kappa$ be a finite diagram. We apply the previous paragraph not to D itself, but to the induced localization

$$\text{Fun}(J, C) \rightleftarrows \text{Fun}(J, D).$$

Since J is finite, Lemma 1.5 shows that $\text{Fun}(J, C)$ is again κ -compactly generated, with κ -compact generators given by diagrams $J \rightarrow C^\kappa$; similarly, F is κ -compact as an object of $\text{Fun}(J, D)$. The right adjoint preserves κ -filtered colimits pointwise. Hence F is a retract, as a diagram, of $LK_\bullet$ for some diagram $K_\bullet: J \rightarrow C^\kappa$.

Taking limits, $\lim_J F$ is a retract of

$$\lim_J LK_\bullet \simeq L(\lim_J K_\bullet),$$

where we used that L preserves finite limits. Since C^κ is closed under finite limits, $\lim_J K_\bullet$ lies in C^κ . Therefore $L(\lim_J K_\bullet)$ is κ -compact in D , and so its retract $\lim_J F$ is κ -compact. $\square$

Lemma A.11. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let C be a small category with finite limits, and let τ be a Grothendieck topology on C . Suppose that the τ -sheaf condition can be tested on a collection of covering sieves*

$$R \subseteq y(c)$$

which are κ -compact as objects of $\text{PSh}(C)$. Then τ -sheaves are closed under κ -filtered colimits in $\text{PSh}(C)$.

In particular, this applies if τ is generated by a pretopology whose covering families have fewer than κ morphisms. More generally, it applies whenever there is such a testing collection in which every sieve is generated by fewer than κ morphisms into the target.

Proof. Let $F \simeq \operatorname{colim}_i F_i$ be a κ -filtered colimit in $\operatorname{PSh}(C)$, where every F_i is a τ -sheaf. Let $R \subseteq y(c)$ be one of the covering sieves in the testing collection. Since $y(c)$ and R are κ -compact in $\operatorname{PSh}(C)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} F(c) &\simeq \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{PSh}(C)}(y(c), F) \\ &\simeq \operatorname{colim}_i \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{PSh}(C)}(y(c), F_i) \\ &\simeq \operatorname{colim}_i \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{PSh}(C)}(R, F_i) \\ &\simeq \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{PSh}(C)}(R, F). \end{aligned}$$

The middle equivalence uses that each F_i satisfies descent for the covering sieve R . Hence F satisfies descent for every sieve in the testing collection, and is therefore a τ -sheaf.

It remains to justify the final assertion. Let $R \subseteq y(c)$ be the sieve generated by a family

$$\{c_a \rightarrow c\}_{a \in A}$$

with A κ -small. Set $U := \coprod_{a \in A} y(c_a)$. The map $U \rightarrow y(c)$ factors through an effective epimorphism $U \rightarrow R$, and R is the geometric realization of its Čech nerve. Since $R \rightarrow y(c)$ is a monomorphism, the terms of this Čech nerve are the corresponding fiber products over $y(c)$:

$$U_n \simeq \coprod_{(a_0, \dots, a_n) \in A^{n+1}} y(c_{a_0} \times_c \cdots \times_c c_{a_n}).$$

Here the indicated finite limits exist in C . Each U_n is a κ -small coproduct of representables, and the simplicial indexing category is countable. Since κ is uncountable regular, $R \simeq |U_\bullet|$ is a κ -small colimit of representables. Such an object is κ -compact: mapping out of it gives a κ -small limit of evaluations, and κ -filtered colimits of anima commute with κ -small limits. $\square$

Corollary A.12. *Let κ be an uncountable regular cardinal, let C be a small category with finite limits, and let τ be a Grothendieck topology on C . Suppose that τ -sheaves are closed under κ -filtered colimits in $\operatorname{PSh}(C)$ (e.g. in the situation of Lemma A.11). Then $\operatorname{Shv}_\tau(C)$ is κ -compactly generated, and the κ -compact objects of $\operatorname{Shv}_\tau(C)$ are closed under finite limits.*

Moreover, sheafification sends κ -compact presheaves to κ -compact sheaves, and every κ -compact sheaf is a retract of a κ -small colimit of sheafified representables.

Proof. Let

$$L: \operatorname{PSh}(C) \rightleftarrows \operatorname{Shv}_\tau(C) : \iota$$

be sheafification and the inclusion. This is an accessible left exact localization, so L preserves finite limits. By assumption, ι preserves κ -filtered colimits. The category $\operatorname{PSh}(C)$ is κ -compactly generated by representables, and Proposition A.9 shows that its κ -compact objects are closed under finite limits. Applying Lemma A.10 gives the first claim.

The same adjunction shows directly that L sends κ -compact presheaves to κ -compact sheaves. The proof of Lemma A.10 also shows that every κ -compact sheaf is a retract of LK for some κ -compact presheaf K . Since κ -compact presheaves are retracts of κ -small colimits of representables, and since such retracts may be absorbed by the usual countable telescope, every κ -compact sheaf is a retract of a κ -small colimit of the objects $Ly(c)$. $\square$

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